

What Backward Negative Concord Tells Us About Control

Abstract. In this article, I propose an analysis of a phenomenon I call Backward Negative Concord (BNC). This is when a negative concord item in a matrix clause is licensed by negation in an embedded clause, contra expectations of standard negative concord requiring clausemate negation or at the very least the c-command of negation. It is shown that BNC appears in control structures in Russian only if the NCI is the controller. I propose that the complementizer introduces a feature responsible for negative concord that gets transmitted to the controller. Finally, cases of BNC occurring with what looks like raising verbs are discussed together with their differences from BNC in control structures.

Keywords. Obligatory Control, (Strict) Negative Concord, Russian *ni*-phrases

1. Introduction. Russian is a strict negative concord language. That is, *ni*-phrases can only occur in the presence of a clausemate negation.¹

- (1) a. Nikto *(ne) smotrit televizor.
nobody NEG watches TV
'Nobody watches TV.'
- b. *Lina ne думаet [čto nikto smotrit televizor].
Lina NEG thinks that nobody watches TV
Int.: 'Lina doesn't think that anyone watches TV.'

Kholodilova (2015), Letuchiy (2017) notice that there seem to be exceptions to that rule. They notice that, in some subject control cases, *ni*-pronouns are licensed in the matrix clause when the negation is in the embedded clause (2). I call this phenomenon Backward Negative Concord: cases in which a Negative Concord Item is allowed to appear in the matrix clause while negation is only present in the embedded clause. Kholodilova (2015) proposes an analysis of the phenomenon based on pragmatics-driven bleaching (Partee et al. 2011). Letuchiy (2017) reduces some of the cases to raising.

- (2) from Kholodilova (2015)
Nikto staralsja [ob etom **ne** vspominat'].
Nobody tried about this NEG recollect
'Everyone tried not to think of it.'

Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020), building on Minor (2013), show that a large class of object control verbs allow the same: a *ni*-pronoun can be licensed in the position of matrix object in the presence of embedded negation. They propose to analyze these instances of *ni*-pronouns as negative floating quantifiers which are located in the embedded clause and are licensed by clausemate negation.

In this article, I propose an analysis of the data on BNC. I also discuss the broader consequences that the BNC data has for the theory of control and Agree. I consider both subject and

¹ Abbreviations: NOM Nominative, ACC Accusative, DAT Dative, INF Infinitive, NEG Negation, PFV Perfective, IPV Imperfective, NCI Negative Concord Item

object control. I provide additional data on the kind of control predicates that do and do not allow Backward Negative Concord. I also show that the only matrix position in which a Negative Concord Item can be licensed by embedded negation is the position of the controller. I argue, based on structure diagnostics (introduced in Section 4.1), for the generalization that

- (3) Backward Negative Concord is only licensed in control complements which show evidence of larger structural complexity and belong to the *Situation* type complements (Wurmbrand & Lohninger 2023).

Based on this generalization, adding case independence facts in BNC structures, I then argue against an account based on the movement theory of control (Hornstein 1999). Based on both an agreement theory of negative concord (Zeijlstra 2004) and agreement theory of control (Landau 2001, Landau 2013, McFadden & Sundaresan 2018, Fischer 2018), I then consequently argue that BNC structures provide evidence for a transitive view of feature transfer under Agree (see Deal 2022, Clem & Deal 2024 for a different implementation). Specifically, I propose, following Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023), that CP control complements in Russian can have a complementizer bearing a feature associated with negative concord morphology. That feature gets valued by clausemate negation and transmitted to the controller through PRO, yielding BNC structures.

The article is organized as follows. In Section 2, I present the basic data on BNC in control complements in Russian. Additional data is available in the Appendix. Section 4 contains a discussion of the properties of the examined structures and motivates a generalization about the kinds of predicates allowing BNC. Section 3 goes over previously proposed analyses and summarizes the crux of the puzzle. Section 5 presents the analysis I propose for these structures. Section 6 goes over some predictions of the current proposal that turn out to be borne out. Section 7 discusses the interpretation and quantificational force of NCIs in BNC structures. Section 8 discusses the special case of *try*-class predicates. I discuss BNC with raising predicates in Section 9. Section 10 concludes the article. The appendix contains additional data for different control predicates with respect to BNC.

2. The phenomenon.

2.1. SUBJECT CONTROL.

2.1.1. PREDICATES ALLOWING BNC. Some subject control predicates in Russian, at least for some speakers, allow for a *ni*-pronoun (a Negative Concord Item) to be in the subject position even when negation is only present in the embedded clause. Cases in which an NCI is present in the matrix clause and negation is only present in the embedded clause. I will henceforth call Backward Negative Concord (BNC).

The data in this article, unless another source is specified, has been gathered through consultation with 5 native Russian speakers ages 25-50yo. BNC structures in Russian are highly colloquial. In this article, I am mostly using a binary system to reflect judgments: acceptable or unacceptable. This is, of course, a simplification of the facts. Given that the purpose of this article is to address the unexpected fact that these structures are anything but unacceptable, I focus mostly on the binary distinction here. A quantitative study to fine-grain the contrasts between the various degrees of acceptability between the acceptable examples reported here is left to further research.

(4)–(5) illustrate the BNC structures with subject control. In all the examples below, the negative quantifier ‘nobody’ is interpreted as a universal quantifier in the matrix clause scoping over the negation in the embedded clause.

- (4) **Nikto** rešil [ne prixodit’]
 nobody.NOM decided NEG come.INF
 ‘Everyone decided not to come.’
- (5) **Nikto** nadejalsja [ego zdes’ bol’še ne uvidet’].
 nobody.NOM hoped he.ACC here anymore NEG see.INF
 ‘Everyone hoped not to see him here again.’

Importantly, in the examples above, the NCI subject is interpreted in the matrix clause. Apart from the interpretations, this can also be seen in (6).

- (6) **Nikto_i** v **svoe_i** vremja rešil [ne prixodit’]
 nobody.NOM in REFL time decided NEG come.INF
 ‘Everyone in their own mind decided not to come.’

To sum up, Backward Negative Concord can be licensed with the following predicates (additional data on these and other predicates is provided in the Appendix):

- (7) Subject control predicates that allow BNC
rešit’ ‘to decide’, *nadejat’sja* ‘to hope’, *bojat’sja* ‘to fear’, *predpočitat’* ‘to prefer’, *planirovat’* ‘to plan’, *sobirat’sja* ‘to intend’, *xotet’* ‘to want’, *obeščat’* ‘to promise’, *riskovat’* ‘to risk’.

2.1.2. PREDICATES DISALLOWING BNC. This Section shows that implicative, factive and aspectual subject control predicates do not allow Backward Negative Concord.

Uspet’ ‘to manage in time’, *zabyvat’* ‘to forget’ are implicative subject control verbs in Russian. They do not allow Backward Negative Concord (8)–(9).²

- (8) Context: Multiple people were entering a cafe that had a cat nearby that was quick to try to sneak into the cafe after the person.
 ***Nikto** uspel [ne vpustit’ košku].
 nobody.NOM managed.in.time NEG let.in.INF cat
 Int.: ‘Everyone managed to (close the door behind them in time to) not let the cat in.’

² For all the ungrammatical BNC sentences in this article, the corresponding sentences with *vse* ‘all’/ *každyj* ‘every(one)’ as the subject instead of *nikto* ‘nobody’ are grammatical. This is shown explicitly for *zabyvat’* ‘to forget’ in (9). Thus, I take the ungrammaticality of *nikto* in the subject position to be due to its NCI status and not any other verb-specific factors.

- (9) a. Context: Vera is not very good at giving advice.
 Vse (večno) zabyvali [ne slušat' Verinyx sovetov].
 all always forgot NEG listen.INF Vera's advice
 'Everyone kept forgetting not to listen to Vera's advice.'
- b. ***Nikto** (večno) zabyval [ne slušat' Verinyx sovetov].
 nobody.NOM always forgot NEG listen.INF Vera's advice
 Int.: 'Everyone kept forgetting not to listen to Vera's advice.'

(10)–(11) show that aspectual predicates also do not license Backward Negative Concord.

- (10) ***Nikto** načal [ne vpolnjat' plan].
 Nobody began NEG fulfill.INF plan
 Int.: 'Everyone started to not fulfill the (production) plan.'
- (11) ***Nikto** prekratil/ perestal [ne slušat'sja].
 nobody.NOM stopped stopped NEG obey.INF
 Int.: 'Everyone stopped disobeying (=misbehaving).'

Another class of subject control predicates that do not allow BNC is factives.

- (12) ***Nikto** ljubil/ nenavidel [ne rabotat'].
 Nobody.NOM loved/ hated NEG work.INF
 Int.: 'Everyone loved/hated not to work.'
- (13) Context: Kids are playing a game in which one person signals the rest to freeze until they pronounce a code word. The person whose turn it is to signal is taking a very long time to release everyone from the need to stay still.
 ***Nikto** ustal [ne dvigat'sja].
 nobody.NOM got.tired NEG move.INF
 Int: 'Everyone got tired of not moving.'

To sum up, Backward Negative Concord is not licensed with the following predicates:

- (14) Subject control predicates that do not allow BNC
- Implicatives**
Uspet 'to manage in time', *zabyvat* 'to forget';
- Aspectuals**
načat 'begin', *prekratit* 'stop', *perestat* 'stop';
- Factives**
ljubit 'love', *nenavidet* 'hate', *ustat* 'to get tired of'.

2.2. OBJECT CONTROL. As originally noticed in Minor (2013), some object control verbs allow for their object to be interpreted in the embedded clause. Minor talks about three diagnostics: scope of numeral expressions, *nibud*’-pronoun licensing, and *ni*-pronoun licensing (the NCIs). Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020) provide a list of speech act causation verbs – the predicates for which these three diagnostics of embedded scope of the surface object pattern together.

- (15) Speech act causation verbs indicate embedded position of the ‘object’ (Lyutikova & Tatevosov 2020:96)
velet ‘to order’, *prikazat* ‘to order’, *dozvolit* ‘to allow’, *pozvolit* ‘to permit’, *posovetovat* ‘to advise’, *porekommendovat* ‘to recommend’, *poprosit* ‘to ask’, *razrešit* ‘to permit’, *poručit* ‘to entrust’...

With these predicates, it is possible to license an NCI-‘object’ with negation in the embedded clause.

- (16) (Russian National Corpus)
 Predsedatel’ poprosil **nikogo** **ne** obizhat’sja.
 chair asked nobody.ACC NEG get.offended.INF
 ‘The chair asked for nobody to get offended.’

Burukina (2020) argues that mandative object control predicates like *prikazat* ‘order’, *razrešit* ‘permit’ can embed non-finite clauses with both covert subjects (PRO controlled by the dative matrix Holder) and overt dative subjects. In the case of an overt subject, Burukina shows that the embedded subject can be an NCI.

- (17) (Burukina 2020:22)
 Ivan velel **nikomu** **ne** prixodit’.
 Ivan ordered nobody.DAT NEG come.INF
 ‘Ivan ordered that nobody would come.’

In (16)–(17), the NCIs are interpreted in the embedded clause. Both Burukina (2020) and Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020) contrast these predicates with other object control predicates in that only the former show evidence of the DP that on the surface looks like the matrix controller being merged in the embedded clause.

Yet Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020) show that other object control verbs, those that do not show evidence of the surface object being in the embedded clause, also allow the NCI to be the matrix object with negation in the embedded clause. (18) shows an example of Backward Negative Concord with an implicative predicate.

- (18) ³ from [\[ranobe website\]](#)
 Žar zastavil **nikogo** **ne** približat’sja k nemu.
 heat forced nobody.ACC NEG approach.INF to him
 ‘The heat made everyone not come close to him.’

³ (Burukina 2020:23) provides a parallel example that is judged ungrammatical. Given that the speakers I consulted accept this and Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020) report these verbs as allowing NCIs in the object, I suggest that there seems to be a dialectal split in the acceptability of these sentences.

Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020) claim that this configuration (which is referred to as BNC in this article) is possible with the predicates in (19)–(20). They note that implicative verbs and conative verbs in perfective aspect do not show evidence that the object DP can be interpreted in the embedded clause. Conatives in imperfective aspect, along with speech act causation verbs, do exhibit such evidence (the diagnostics include interpretation of indefinite numerals, *nibud*’-pronoun licensing and others, see Lyutikova & Tatevosov 2020:98).

- (19) Implicative causation verbs allow BNC (Lyutikova & Tatevosov 2020:96)
vynudit ‘to compel’, *zastavit* ‘to force’, *objazat* ‘to oblige’, *prinudit* ‘to compel’, *pomoč* ‘to help’, *pomešat* ‘to hinder’, *dat* ‘*vozmožnost*’ ‘to enable/give opportunity’ ...
- (20) Conative⁴ speech act verbs allow BNC (Lyutikova & Tatevosov 2020:97)
ugovarivat ‘to talk.into’, *uprašivat* ‘to beg’, *umol’at* ‘to plead’, *soblazn’at* ‘to tempt’, *zamanivat* ‘to entice’ ...

Summing up, Backward Negative Concord seems to be licensed with any object control verb. As will be argued later in Section 3.1, what looks like BNC with speech act (or mandative) verbs calls for a different explanation, which cannot be extended to the rest of the predicates showing BNC discussed here.

2.3. BNC LICENSING CONDITIONS. In the BNC structures above the NCI is licensed in the matrix clause in the presence of negation in the embedded clause. As expected, the same NCIs become ungrammatical in the absence of embedded negation. This is illustrated for examples (18) and (4) repeated below in (21)–(22).

- (21) *Žar zastavil nikogo* [**(ne) približat’sja k nemu*].
 heat forced nobody.ACC NEG approach.INF to him
 ‘The heat made everyone not come close to him.’
- (22) *Nikto rešil* [**(ne) prixodit’*].
 nobody.NOM decided NEG come.INF
 ‘Everyone decided not to come.’

In all of the above examples of NCIs in the matrix clause getting licensed when the negation is in the embedded clause, crucially, the position in which such NCIs are licensed is the position of the controller. (23)–(24) show that NCIs are not licensed in other positions in these structures. In (23), only the object can be an NCI, while the subject cannot. In (24), only the subject can be an NCI while an NCI-adjunct can only be interpreted as having been scrambled from the embedded clause. In the case of *obeščat* ‘promise’, BNC is not possible with the NCI being the dative object of ‘promise’ (25).

⁴ These are verbs that, in imperfective aspect, denote attempts, while denoting accomplishments in perfective aspect.

- (23) a. ***Nikto** ubedil Petju [ne uxodit’].
 Nobody persuaded Petya.ACC NEG leave.INF
 ‘Int.: Everyone asked/ persuaded Petya not to leave.’
 b. Petja ubedil **nikogo** [ne uxodit’].
 Petya persuaded nobody.ACC NEG leave.INF
 ‘Petya persuaded everyone not to leave./...asked for nobody to leave.’
- (24) a. #Petja [**ni** na kakom zastol’e] rešil [ne golosovat’ za Putina].
 Petya NCI at any dinner decided NEG vote.INF for Putin
 i.*‘At every/no dinner party, Petya made a decision not to vote for Putin.’
 ii. ‘Petya made a decision to vote for Putin at every dinner party.’
 b. **Nikto** rešil [ne golosovat’ za Putina].
 nobody.NOM decided NEG vote for Putin
 ‘Everyone decided not to vote for Putin.’
- (25) ⁵ *Petja obeščal **nikomu** [ne napivat’sja]
 Petja.NOM promised nobody.DAT NEG get.drunk.INF
 Int.: ‘Petya promised everyone not to get drunk.’

To conclude the Section, BNC is licensed with object control predicates and certain subject control predicates. In all cases, the negative concord item is only licensed in the presence of embedded negation and only in the position of the controller.

3. The puzzle.

3.1. ALTERNATIVE STRUCTURES. In this section, I consider alternative analyses of the underlying structures in Section 2, which place the NCI in BNC structures in the embedded clause at a point in the derivation. I argue that they do not account for the data.

Firstly, the behavior exhibited in BNC constructions clearly brings up the possibility that all the cases where BNC is allowed are cases of raising (or ECM in the case of object control). However, that does not hold up when raising diagnostics are considered. Firstly, both Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020) and Burukina (2020) argue that object control verbs to the exclusion of speech act causation/mandative verbs (on which the authors of the two referenced works disagree) do not pass the tests for raising (truth conditions under passivization change, subject idioms do not retain idiomatic interpretation). Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020) also show that implicative and conative verbs (see (19) and (20) also do not show evidence of embedded scope of the object DP they do not allow their object to be interpreted in the embedded clause. The same can be easily shown for the subject control predicates allowing BNC and, in fact, Russian is often considered to lack typical raising-to-subject predicates (see e.g. Lyutikova 2022).

That being said, predicates taking infinitival complements can sometimes exhibit ambiguity between their raising and control versions. Thus, it is worth considering the possibility that when BNC is allowed the predicates in question are acting as raising/ECM predicates. At least

⁵ This example can be perceived as acceptable, however, forcing a strange interpretation that Petya made a promise that noone would get drunk or something along these lines. That interpretation is hard to access. It is impossible under the provided interpretation or under the interpretation that there is no person such that Petya promised them not to get drunk.

two widely-used diagnostics can be cross-referenced with BNC: (i) effect of passivization on truth-conditions, (ii) selectional restrictions of the matrix verb on the suspected raised argument. Passivization can be shown to change the truth conditions of the predicates allowing BNC. To save space this is only illustrated for one subject and one object control predicate allowing BNC in (26)–(27).

- (26) a. **Nikto** nadejalsja [**ne** uvidet' Ellu].
 nobody.NOM hoped NEG see.INF Ella.ACC
 'Everyone hoped not to see Ella.' ($\neq b$)
- b. Ella nadejalsja' [**ne** byt' uvidennoj **nikem**].
 Ella.NOM hoped nobody.INST NEG see.INF
 'She hoped not to be seen by anyone.' ($\neq a$)
- (27) a. Maša zastavila **nikogo** [**ne** zvat' Vasju].
 Masha forced nobody.ACC NEG call.INF Vasya.ACC
 'Masha made everyone not invite Vasya.' ($\neq b$)
- b. Maša zastavila Vasju [**ne** byt' pozvannym **nikem**].
 Masha forced nobody.ACC NEG call.INF Vasya.ACC nobody.INST
 'Masha made Vasya not be invited by anyone.' ($\neq a$)

It can also be shown that even with BNC matrix predicates still impose selectional restrictions on the suspected raised argument. Example (28) illustrates this for two of the verbs.

- (28) a. ***Ničto** nadejalos' / ^{OK}**nikto** nadejalsja [**ne** upast'].
 nothing.NOM hoped nobody.NOM hoped.M.SG NEG fall.INF
 '*Everything/ Everyone hoped not to fall.'
- b. Maša zastavila ***ničego** / ^{OK}**nikogo** [**ne** prixodit'].
 Masha forced nothing.ACC nobody.ACC NEG come.INF
 'Masha made *everything/ everyone not come.'

As has been mentioned in Section 2.2, some object control predicates have been given ECM-type structures in which the surface controller is actually an overt embedded subject that gets case from the matrix clause (see Burukina 2020 for mandative predicates, Lyutikova & Tatevosov 2020 for speech act causative and imperfective conative predicates). In the case of such structures, the controller-NCI syntactic licensing can be argued to follow since there is still (embedded) clausemate negation to take care of it.⁶ Given that and the fact that interpretations for BNC with speech act/mandative predicates in (16)–(17), I will omit these cases from further consideration in the paper. That being the case, this still leaves implicatives and perfective conatives which still require a separate mechanism to account for Backward Negative Concord.

⁶ An anonymous reviewer notes that in this case there would still be an issue of scope. In BNC examples the NCIs are interpreted as universal quantifiers scoping over the embedded negation ($\forall > \neg$). In case of the NCI being in the embedded clause, given that it needs to be licensed by c-commanding negation, one may expect the scope to be the opposite ($\forall > \neg$), which is not what the attested examples show, as the relative scope in examples like (16) is $\forall > \neg$, which is equivalent to $(\neg > \exists)$. This problem, however, can be avoided by following Giannakidou (2000) in proposing that NCI-universals undergo obligatory QR at LF.

Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020) suggest that *ni*-pronouns that are seemingly objects in the matrix clause are actually embedded negative floating quantifiers (NFQs). While that may be the case for some of the examples discussed in Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020), it doesn't seem to account for all of Backward Negative Concord situations. For one, the object does not have to be just the one *ni*-pronoun, it can be a full phrase *nikogo iz klientov* 'none of the clients' (29), which typically cannot act as an NFQs⁷. Another potential challenge for this analysis is that the *ni*-pronoun and another floating quantifier don't have to agree in case. However, *ni*-pronouns used as NFQs always agree with their respective DP (in this case, PRO).

- (29) a. Petja vynudil **nikogo** **iz klientov** ne uxodit.
 Petja forced nobody.ACC of clients NEG leave.INF
 'Petja forced all of the clients not to leave.'
- b. Profesor predupredil **nikogo** ne podnimat' čemodan **samomu**.
 professor warned nobody.ACC NEG lift.INF suitcase oneself.DAT
 'Professor warned everyone to not lift the suitcase on their own.'

An anonymous reviewer points out an interesting prosodic fact: the object control BNC cases require that the NCI-controller be pronounced together with the embedded clause, while non-NCI controllers may be pronounced with a pause separating them from the infinitive. This could be indicative of a closer relationship between the NCI-controller and the embedded clause. This would diverge from the evidence presented so far in (27)–(28b) suggesting that even with the NCI-controller, the structure maintains the properties of control as opposed to raising/ECM. An analysis of object NCIs as NFQs in object control cases is challenged by the facts in (29), but potentially not impossible. However, the prosodic facts can also possibly be accounted for without taking the NFQ route. As Nespor & Vogel (2007) lay it out, Intonational Phrases can undergo restructuring. In fact, Richards (2016) argues for a theory according to which *wh*-phrases must be prosodically contiguous to interrogative Cs and proposes to extend this to all probe-goal relations. Although, the proper examination and account of the prosodic facts in BNC constructions is beyond the scope of this article, I suggest that this is a promising direction for such an account.

Given that the alternatives discussed here do not give full coverage to the BNC facts presented, namely, the subject control cases cannot be explained by raising, and at least the implicative and perfective conative object control cases do not seem to involve raising, ECM or FNQs, this article will attempt providing a novel account for the mechanism behind BNC structures.

3.2. POTENTIAL ANALYSES. BNC constructions presented in Section 2 present a challenge, primarily, to the view that an NCI needs to get (syntactically) licensed by a negation that c-commands it (see Zeijlstra 2004 a.o.). Indeed, given that the NCIs are matrix generated, they are never c-commanded by negation in BNC structures (hence, the name I propose here). However, this view is not unanimous. In fact, Rossyaykin (2022) uses examples parallel to those presented here for the case of subject control BNC as evidence that NCIs probe downward for negation, which means, they get licensed by a negation that *they* c-command.

An account stating that NCIs in BNC get licensed by probing directly downward for the embedded negation meets two apparent challenges. Firstly, not all subject control verbs allow BNC: implicatives, aspectuals and factives do not. It could be suggested that there is something in the

⁷ I thank Sergei Minor for this observation.

structure between the NCI and the embedded negation that blocks the NCI-licensing the Agree dependency. However, this doesn't seem to be the case: when the negation is in the matrix clause and the NCI is in the embedded, the dependency is allowed. Gerasimova (2015), Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023) show that in some Russian control structures an NCI can be licensed in the embedded infinitive by a negation in the matrix clause. This is referred to as Long-Distance Negative Concord (LDNC). Specifically, this is easy to show for the predicates disallowing BNC in Section 2.1.2 (see ex.30 with the implicative *uspet* 'manage in time' for illustration). Beyond BNC structures, LDNC seems to pose a problem for the assumption that NCIs probe downward for negation to be licensed.

(30) (Russian National Corpus)

On daže **ne** uspel [predupredit' **nikogo**] ...
 he even NEG managed.in.time warn.INF nobody.ACC
 'He didn't even manage (have time) to warn anyone.'

Compare (30) to (8) repeated above.

(31) Context: Multiple people were entering a cafe that had a cat nearby that was quick to try to sneak into the cafe after the person.

***Nikto** uspel [**ne** vpustit' košku].
 nobody.NOM managed.in.time NEG let.in.INF cat

Int.: 'Everyone managed to (close the door behind them in time to) not let the cat in.'

Another challenge for an account of BNC through direct downward probing by the NCI is the fact that, as demonstrated in Section 2.3, NCIs in the matrix clause in BNC can only be controllers. These structures do not license the NCIs in other positions in the matrix clause.

Given these considerations, in this article, I will attempt an account based on the assumption that NCIs need to be c-commanded by negation at some point in the derivation to be (syntactically) licensed.⁸

4. The structural divide in control complements. In this Section, I motivate the generalization in (32).

(32) Backward Negative Concord is only licensed in control complements which show evidence of larger structural complexity and belong to the *Situation* type complements (Wurmbrand 2001).

4.1. STRUCTURE DIAGNOSTICS. Embedded clauses come in a variety of sizes. Wurmbrand (2001) argues that complements of certain (often cross-linguistically parallel) predicates involve restructuring. That is, certain predicates usually take infinitival complements that are structurally smaller than a full CP. Some diagnostics for restructuring considered by Wurmbrand are not applicable in case of Russian. These include clitic climbing and long passives. A diagnostic property that it is possible to apply to Russian infinitivals has to do with the level of independence

⁸ These assumptions also interact with the quantificational force presumed behind NCIs. This matter is addressed directly in Section 7

that embedded Tense has. Wurmbrand & Lohninger (2023) divide clausal complements into three broad semantic categories: *Proposition*, *Situation* and *Event*. These groups form a semantic implicational complementation hierarchy and are built on one another through containment in syntax. Propositions are the most independent, the least transparent, *Situations* are less so, and *Events* are the most restricted. Relative to their temporal interpretation, Propositions have an embedded reference time, which is the attitude holder’s NOW, and are interpreted as simultaneous with the matrix clause. *Situations* have no embedded reference time and a pre-specified tense value, most commonly future. *Events* are tenseless and interpreted as simultaneous with the matrix clause. Wurmbrand & Lohninger (2023) indicate that *Events* usually only allow exhaustive control, while partial control (PC) is possible with *Propositions* and *Situations*.

Another distinction also comes from the TMA domain: aspect. According to Wurmbrand & Lohninger (2023), *Proposition* complements cannot occur with perfective because their reference time is the attitude holder’s NOW, a very short interval which cannot contain the event time. *Situation* complements can appear with both perfective and imperfective because their reference time is a potentially infinite future interval, which can contain the event time allowing for perfective. Based on this, I assume that it is expected for embedded aspect in *Events* to be dependent on the matrix aspect. In case the matrix predicate is imperfective, meaning that the reference time is included in event time, the subevent time can both include reference time (imperfective) and be included in reference time (perfective). However, if the matrix clause predicate is perfective, meaning that the event time is included in reference time, no subevent can include reference time.

The minimal requirement for Events is the presence of a theta-domain ($\sim vP$), for Situations – a T(ense)M(odality)A(spect)-domain ($\sim TP$), for Propositions – the operator domain ($\sim CP$). The authors specifically point out that this claim specifies not maximal, but minimal syntactic structure corresponding to the three semantic types of complements. *Event* complements, which are expected to potentially involve the most radical restructuring, are the complements of implicatives, aspectuals and *try*-class predicates⁹.

Another restructuring diagnostic that is possible to apply to Russian has to do with elements that require negation to be licensed. Wurmbrand & Lohninger (2023) and Grano (2015) both use NCI licensing. Indeed, NCI licensing usually has to involve a local relationship, often characterized as clausemate. Grano (2015) shows that only restructuring complements license long-distance negative concord, meaning that matrix negation can license an embedded NCI. Thus the less transparent complements are predicted to be the more structurally complex ones.

One large class of predicates allowing Backward Negative Concord is the class of object control predicates. Object control infinitives in Russian differ from subject control infinitives. A difference that has received a lot of attention since Comrie (1974), Babby (1998) is the availability of the ‘second dative’. Agreeing Floating Quantifiers (*ves* ‘all’, and the semi-predicatives *odin* ‘alone’ and *sam* ‘oneself’) can only bear nominative case in subject control structures (33a) while having dative case in object control structures (33b) ¹⁰.

- (33) a. Lev rešil [prijeti odin/ *odnomu].
 Lev decided come.INF alone.NOM/ alone.DAT
 ‘Lev decided to come alone.’

⁹ Discussed in Section 8

¹⁰ This dative was later shown by Landau (2008) to be optional and alternating with accusative for object control

- b. Lev ubedil Stasa [prijeti odnogo/ odnomu].
 Lev persuaded Stas.ACC come.INF alone.ACC/ alone.DAT
 ‘Lev persuaded Stas to come alone.’

Importantly, these FQs agree in case with a clausemate DP they are predicated of. Based on this fact together with (i.) the fact that the default case of Russian predicates is instrumental, and (ii.) the fact that these FQs cannot be complements of *seem/consider*, which need to be non-case-agreeing predicates (Bailyn 2001), Landau (2008) concludes that ‘second dative’ has to come from agreement with PRO and is not a default case.

Independent of their stance on the source of ‘second dative’, accounts of the asymmetry between subject and object control complements are based on structural differences between them (Greenberg & Franks 1991, Babby 1998, Testelefs 2001). In particular, Babby (1998), Testelefs (2001), Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023) argue that object control complements are more structurally complex than subject control ones. This is argued because dative case availability for PRO correlates with the presence of a CP-layer in infinitives: it is available in purpose clauses with the *čtoby* ‘to, in order to’ complementizer, *wh*-infinitives and embedded *yes/no* infinitives.

Landau (2008), Bailyn (2012), Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023) assume that it is the infinitival C that assigns dative to PRO. Thus, I will treat the availability of this type of dative as a potential indicator of a larger structure, namely CP.

Another property correlated with higher structural complexity in control infinitives is the availability of PC. (Landau 2015, McFadden & Sundaresan (2018), Wurmbrand & Lohninger (2023)). Under the Agree-based theory of control (Landau 2001, and later implementation in McFadden & Sundaresan 2018), PC has to be mediated by the embedded C head. In fact, this coincides with the Russian-internal diagnostic laid out above: although normally subject control infinitives do not have a ‘second dative’, Landau (2008) shows that, in case of PC, the dative appears and becomes obligatory.

- (34) a. from Landau 2008:908
 My predpočli sobratsja vse/ ??vsem v šest’.
 we.NOM preferred to.gather all.NOM/ all.DAT in six.
 ‘We decided to all gather at six.’
 b. Predsedatel’ predpočel sobratsja vsem/ *vse v šest’.
 chair.NOM preferred to.gather all.DAT/ all.NOM in six
 ‘The chair preferred to all gather at six.’

This suggests that subject control predicates that allow PC in Russian can also, like object control ones, take a CP as a complement.

That property can be correlated with another one: according to Landau (2015), it is exactly attitude complements that allow PC. Based on the view that attitude predicates are quantifiers over sets of contexts, which are taken to be tuples of coordinates $i = \langle \text{AUTHOR}(i), \text{ADDRESSEE}(i), \text{TIME}(i), \text{WORLD}(i) \rangle$, Landau suggests that these coordinates may project in the syntax as a specifier of C. Namely, this is what happens to the $\text{AUTHOR}(i)$ or $\text{ADDRESSEE}(i)$ coordinate in obligatory control. This analysis brings together Landau’s generalizations that attitude complements, semantically tensed complements (those that allow temporal modification conflicting with the

matrix one), and PC complements are the same set. Under this view, the availability of PC relies on the logophoric nature of this type of control which is facilitated by the AUTHOR(i) or ADDRESSEE(i) coordinate projected in Spec,CP. The availability of conflicting temporal modification also follows: the embedded context has its own set of coordinates, including TIME(i). Based on this work, obligatory control differentiates between two types: predicative and logophoric control. Predicative control obtains in non-attitude control complements and forces exhaustive control. Logophoric control relies on extra structure, allows for PC and obtains in attitude complements.

Thus, attitudinality, the possibility of conflicting temporal modification and the availability of PC are the indicators of logophoric control, which, for Landau, involves more structure in the complement. In the following subsection, I summarize the properties of predicates from Section 2 against the diagnostics discussed above.

4.2. DIAGNOSTICS RESULTS.

4.2.1. ATTITUDE. The subject control verbs allowing BNC can be shown to select attitude complements. To show that, I will use two diagnostics. Firstly, referential expressions give rise to the de re/de dicto ambiguity, and cannot be substituted equivalently. Say, Sasha's old classmate Adel' was just hired by Sasha's employer, which Sasha is not yet aware of. In this case, (35a) $\nRightarrow$ (35b). The same can be shown for all of the predicates above.

- (35) a. Sasha obeščal/ nadejalsja/ rešil [uvidet'sja s Adelem].
 Sasha promised/ hoped/ decided meet.INF with Adel
 'Sasha promised/hoped/decided to meet with Adel.' $a \nRightarrow b$
- b. Sasha obeščal/ nadejalsja/ rešil [uvidet'sja s novym kollegoj].
 Sasha promised/ hoped/ decided meet.INF with new colleague
 'Sasha promised/hoped/decided to meet with the new colleague.'

Another test used in Landau (2015) is based on the fact that indefinite DPs within attitude complements, unlike in nonattitude ones, do not have an existence entailment. In (36), there is no entailment of the existence of the apple in question. The same is true for all of the subject control predicates allowing BNC.

- (36) Sasha obeščal/ nadejalsja/ rešil [porezat' jabloko].
 Sasha promised/ hoped/ decided slice.INF apple
 'Sasha promised/hoped/decided to slice an apple.'

Out of subject control verbs, implicatives and aspectuals do not pass the two tests above. (37)–(38) illustrates that for implicatives. In (37), (37)a $\Rightarrow$ (37)b. In (38), the indefinite DP does have an existence entailment.

- (37) a. Sasha uspel [uvidet'sja s Adelem].
 Sasha managed.in.time meet.INF with Adel
 'Sasha promised/hoped/decided to meet with Adel.' $a \Rightarrow b$
- b. Sasha uspel [uvidet'sja s novym kollegoj].
 Sasha managed.in.time meet.INF with new colleague
 'Sasha promised/hoped/decided to meet with the new colleague.'

- (38) Sasha uspel [porezat' jabloko].
 Sasha managed.in.time slice.INF apple
 'Sasha promised/hoped/decided to slice an apple.'

The same diagnostics applied to object control verbs under consideration show that conative predicates take attitude complements, and implicatives do not. These examples are not provided for reasons of space.

These diagnostics are harder to apply to the factive subject control predicates considered in the paper. For the first test, the difficulty is that at least for *ljubit* 'love', *nenavidet* 'hate' and *ustat* 'get tired of', 'X loves/hates/tired that P' entails 'X believes that P'. This makes the de re/de dicto test difficult to apply: to evaluate the truth conditions of an analogue of the potential entailment (35)b, which would be *Sasha loved meeting his new colleague*, one has to presuppose that Sasha met his new colleague and is aware of this, which is contradicting the context. As for the indefinite DP test, all these predicates impose imperfective aspect of the embedded clause which, together with these embedded contexts, imposes a definite reading to a singular DP. Though factives are typically attitude predicates, I will thus remain agnostic about the attitudinality of these particular ones.

4.2.2. PARTIAL CONTROL. It can be shown that subject control verbs allowing BNC (*rešit* 'to decide', *nadejat'sja* 'to hope' etc.) and factives allow PC (39a). Implicatives and aspectuals do not (39b).

- (39) a. Mama_i nadej alas' / ljubila [PRO_{i+} užinat' vmeste].
 mom hoped loved have.dinner.INF together
 'Mom hoped to have dinner together (as a family).'
- b. *Mama_i uspela [PRO_{i+} použinat' vmeste].
 mom managed.in.time have.dinner.INF together
 'Mom had time(/managed) to have dinner together (as a family).'

As for object control predicates, Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020) report that the complements of implicatives and perfective conatives allow split and PC.¹¹

4.2.3. TEMPORAL RELATIONS. Subject control predicates that were shown to allow BNC in Section 2.1.1 can also be shown to permit conflicting temporal modification of the embedded clause.

- (40) Včera Nataša nadej alas' zavtra prijti.
 yesterday Natasha hoped tomorrow come.INF
 'Yesterday, Natasha hoped to come tomorrow.'

Subject control implicatives do not allow conflicting tense modifiers (41). The same is true of aspectual and factive subject control predicates. The complements of these predicates are interpreted as simultaneous with the matrix clause.

¹¹ As is discussed further in the paper, I assume that this is correlated with a few other properties that are subject to a dialectal split. Namely, I assume that the speakers whose judgments are reported in Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020) and the current article differ from those whose judgments are reported in Burukina (2020) in that the former but not the latter allow for conflicting T modification, PC and BNC with implicative object control predicates.

- (41) ***Včera** Sajana uspela [**segodnja** vernut'sja].
 yesterday Sayana did.in.time today return.INF
 Int.: 'Yesterday, Sayana managed to return today in time.'

As for object control predicates, most of them allow conflicting temporal modification. The complements of implicative object control verbs tend to not be acceptable with conflicting temporal modification of the matrix and embedded clauses. However, at least some speakers, including the speakers that have been consulted for this article, allow to modify the embedded clause with a temporal adverb that conflicts with the tense of the matrix clause.

- (42) mail.ru
 ...mama zastavila ⟨menja⟩ [**zavtra** idti v školu].
 mom forced.PST me **tomorrow** go.INF in school
 'Mom forced me to go to school tomorrow.'

4.2.4. EMBEDDED ASPECT INDEPENDENCE. It can be easily shown that most considered subject control predicates do not impose any restrictions on embedded aspect. The picture is different for aspectual or implicative subject control predicates (43). Aspectual predicates can only have imperfective complements. Implicatives restrict embedded aspect to perfective in case the matrix verb is perfective. If the matrix verb is imperfective, the embedded verb can also be imperfective.

- (43) a. Nastja zabyła prijti/ *prijodit'.
 Nastya forgot.PFV come.PFV.INF come.IPV.INF
 'Nastya forgot to come.'
 b. Nastja zabyvala prijti/ prijodit'.
 Nastya forgot.PFV come.PFV.INF come.IPV.INF
 'Nastya (repeatedly) forgot to come.'

Factives also restrict the aspect of the embedded complement (44):¹²

- (44) Nastja ustala pisat' / *napisat' statji.
 Nastya tired.of write.IPV.INF write.PFV.INF articles
 'Nastya hated to write articles.'

Out of object control verbs, none of them restrict the aspect of the embedded clause.

¹² The verb *ljubit* 'to love' mostly prefers imperfective complements. However, there is a specific iterative 'from time to time' meaning that arises when the complement is perfective. Notably, that is not the meaning expected from perfectives.

- (i) a. Petja ljubil pisat' pis'ma.
 Petya loved write.IPV.INF letters
 'Petya loved writing letters.'
 b. Petja ljubil (inogda) napisat' pis'mo.
 Petya loved sometimes write.PFV.INF pis'mo.
 'From time to time, Petya enjoyed writing a letter.'

This perfective complement can be modified with *inogda* 'sometimes' even when the matrix predicate is perfective itself, even though perfectives cannot normally be modified by this adverb.

4.2.5. LONG DISTANCE NEGATIVE CONCORD. Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023) conclude that LDNC is possible with both subject and object control in Russian. The object control verbs used in the experiment cover all the groups of object control verbs investigated in Section 2. The authors note that object control structures with LDNC receive lower ratings than LDNC with subject control. However, they show that they are still significantly better than ungrammatical fillers. The authors conclude that the LDNC object control structures are grammatical.

The subject control verbs used in the experiment include aspectual verbs (*načínat'* 'to begin', *perestavat'* 'cease'), try-class predicates (*starat'sja* 'to try', *pytat'sja* 'to attempt', *probovat'* 'to try/attempt'), *riskovat'* 'to risk', and *toropit'sja* 'to hurry'. It can be shown that long-distance negative concord is also possible with other subject control verbs under examination in the current article.

(45) a. BNC-allowing verbs:¹³

Konsul'tant **ne** bojalsja/ rešal [**nikomu** pomogat'].
 adviser NEG feared decided promised help.INF nobody.DAT
 'The adviser didn't fear/decide/promise to help anyone.'

b. Implicatives:

Konsul'tant **ne** uspel/ zabyt [**nikomu** pomoč'].
 adviser NEG did.in.time forgot help.INF nobody.DAT
 'The adviser didn't fear/love/refuse to help anyone.'

4.2.6. SECOND DATIVE. Landau (2008) shows that object control complements always have access to second dative, and subject control complements allow second dative in case of PC or, for *obeščat'* 'promise', in case an indirect object is present.

4.2.7. SUMMARY. Thus, we can now assess the relevant properties of infinitival complements of the verbs discussed in Section 2. They are summarized in Table 1. In the columns, 'BNC' shows whether Backward Negative Concord is licensed with the predicate in question, 'Att.' shows whether the predicate takes attitude complements, the 'PC' column indicates whether PC is possible with the corresponding predicates, the 'confl. T' column indicates whether non-simultaneous interpretation is possible in the complement, the 'ind. Asp' column indicates whether the control predicate restricts the aspect in the embedded clause, the 'LDNC' column shows whether Long-Distance negative concord is available, the 'DAT' column indicates the availability of dative FQs in the complement.

Given Table 1, a generalization arises: BNC is only possible with *Situation* type complements (as in Wurmbrand & Lohninger 2023). The complements of aspectuals and implicatives exhibit all hallmarks of radical restructuring. Semantically, they are interpreted simultaneously with the matrix clause, aspect is predetermined by the matrix verb. As far as control type goes, they are non-attitudinal and force exhaustive control. All these properties point toward these complements being *Events* in Wurmbrand & Lohninger (2023)'s classification. Factives' complements are also interpreted simultaneously with the matrix clause, and they cannot be perfective. They are attitudinal and allow PC. These properties fit the *Proposition* class in the classification. Now, the predicates allowing BNC are future-irrealis and do not pose restrictions on embedded aspect. That lands them in the *Situation* type according to the classification in Wurmbrand &

Matrix predicate	BNC	Att.	PC	confl. T	ind. Asp	LDNC	DAT
SC: <i>rešit</i> ‘decide’, <i>nadejat’sja</i> ‘hope’ etc..	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	(only with PC ¹⁴)
OC, PF conatives: <i>ugovorit</i> ‘to talk.into’ etc..	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
OC, implicatives: <i>zas- tavit</i> ‘to force’ etc..	✓	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
SC, factives: <i>ljubit</i> ‘love’ etc...	✗	?	✓	✗	✗	✓	(only with PC)
SC, aspectuals: <i>načat</i> ‘begin’ etc...	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓	✗
SC, implicatives: <i>uspet</i> ‘manage.in.time’ etc...	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓	✗

Table 1. Structure size diagnostics and BNC licensing

Lohninger (2023). Most of them are also attitudinal and they all allow PC. That is, subject control verbs and most object control verbs allowing BNC show properties of logophoric control.

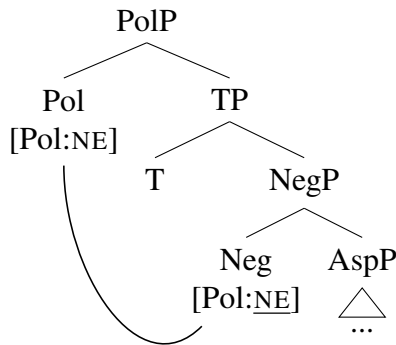
5. Proposal.

5.1. BACKGROUND ON NEGATIVE CONCORD (IN RUSSIAN). Firstly, I assume the view argued for extensively by Zeijlstra (2004), Zeijlstra (2008) that negative concord involves agreement in the narrow syntax and is thus modeled through the operation Agree. Secondly, I follow Gribanova (2017)’s proposal for the Russian clausal structure in relation to negation and polarity. That is, the idea that there are two positions for the expression of polarity in Russian. The higher position, PolP hosts the semantic features, and the lower position, NegP, hosts the morphologically relevant features, including the negative marker (thus following the same intuition as Zeijlstra (2004), who argues that negative markers in strict negative concord languages themselves require licensing by the negative operator). The two loci undergo Agree, which transmits the relevant semantic information to Neg from Pol. This is argued for based on the fact that expletive negation in Russian licenses Genitive of Negation, but not NCIs (based on this being originally observed in Brown & Franks (1995); see also Ruda & Witkoś (2024) for a similar analysis of parallel Polish facts). Another argument for the split of the NC burden between two loci is presented in Erschler (2023). The author shows that a negative operator that is not accompanied by the negative marker *ne* cannot license NCIs, but can license NPIs in Russian. The same can be shown for complements of verbs like *doubt* or *refuse* that are typically analyzed as involving a negative operator in C (Laka 1992), see (46). Erschler (2023) argues that there are multiple negative operators available, with one specifically corresponding to the *ne* marker (he calls it Op_{ne}^{NEG}), and undergoing Agree with NegP, which is hosting the marker.

- (46) Karina otkazalas’ [kogo-libo/ *nikogo podvozit’].
Karina refused who.ACC-NPI nobody.ACC give.ride.INF
‘Karina refused to give a ride to anybody.’

Given these considerations, in this article I adopt a model for NC that captures (i) its Agree-based nature, (ii) the two loci of polarity and NC in Russian, (iii) the fact that there is a specific negative operator licensing *ne*-negation, which I take to mean that it is created with the features relevant for NC in Russian as well. The following model is a simplification, conflating together polarity and morphological NC features. However, given that a full account of the mechanism of NC is outside the scope of this article, it is sufficient to capture the aforementioned properties and, therefore, serve for the purposes of the proposal on BNC in control structures. In this model I depart from Zeijlstra (2004) and model the Agree underlying NC as feature valuation as opposed to checking¹⁵. This is done, following the suggestion of an anonymous reviewer, because the facts discussed above suggest that interpretability of negation does not play a direct role in NC (see also Deal (2021) for arguments against interpretability playing a role in NC), and this allows for capturing the different types of negative operators.

(47) The simplified model of NC in this article



In (47), the value NE on Pol is aimed to capture what Erschler (2023) does through denoting the *ne*-negation operator as Op_{ne}^{NEG} . Neg, bearing the same unvalued [Pol] feature, undergoes Agree with Pol (as in Gribanova (2017)).¹⁶

Another property of Negative Concord in Russian, as mentioned previously, is that it allows Long Distance Negative Concord. *Ni*-elements, the NCIs, can be licensed by matrix negation across an infinitival clause border (Gerasimova 2015, Lyutikova & Gerasimova 2023). The experimental study reported in Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023) shows that matrix negation can license NCIs in both subject and object control complements¹⁷. Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023) propose that, in the case of licensing *ni*-pronouns across an infinitival CP boundary in Russian, which they take to be all object control infinitives, the [*u*NEG] feature on the embedded *ni*-pronoun is associated with the [*i*NEG] feature on the matrix negative operator through a [*u*NEG] feature on C. Thus, it is proposed that the null C involved in obligatory control in Russian can bear a feature associated with NC and, as such, mediate the dependency between the NCI and matrix negation. The

¹⁵ I thank an anonymous reviewer for suggesting this change.

¹⁶ An anonymous reviewer points out that Rudnev (2024) shows that NCIs are licensed in Russian nominalizations. These clearly do not contain the full clausal structure. However, arguments from Gribanova (2017) and others considered in this section seem to suggest that NegP on its own does not host semantic negation or license NCIs. Therefore, since nominalizations can contain semantic negation with the *ne*-marker, it would follow that some instantiation of the Pol head hosting the negative operator is still present in the structure of these nominalizations.

¹⁷ Object control LDNC received lower ratings but is still grammatical according to the authors of the study.

authors note that they are virtually positing a null negative complementizer in Russian, similar to overt negative complementizers found in other languages (McQuillan 2016 for Celtic languages, Laka 1990 for Basque). This complementizer, however, differs in that it does not contribute (interpretable) negation. That is, in fact, the kind of complementizer that Landau (2002) posits for Hebrew, arguing that *me-* ‘from’ is a negative complementizer found in Hebrew infinitival control complements of verbs involving ‘negative’ meaning. He argues that like its finite counterparts in Basque, English, Spanish (Laka 1990, Laka 1992), Serbo-Croatian (Progovac 1993b), C has an interpretable [neg] feature. Landau proposes, that there is also another kind of infinitival negative complementizer in Hebrew – a null complementizer with an uninterpretable [neg] feature. This complementizer diffuses its uninterpretable [neg] feature by entering a local Agree relation with Neg^o. For the model of NC adopted in this paper, this complementizer can be reformulated as bearing an unvalued [Pol:] feature, which makes it a complementizer-NCI.

5.2. ARGUING FOR THE PROPOSAL. As Section 5.1 spells out, the proposed analysis in this article has as its starting point the view of NC as agreement.

As was discussed in Section 3, which is setting up the puzzle, BNC is possible only if the NCI in question is the controller and only in a subset of control complements. All of control complements, including those disallowing BNC, allow LDNC into them. That is taken to mean that NCIs cannot directly probe downward from the matrix clause to achieve BNC. Otherwise, there is no clear way to limit this behavior to only the controller and only in a subset of complements.

Section 4 establishes that the smallest and most transparent infinitival complements, those corresponding to *Events* in Wurmbrand & Lohninger (2023)’s classification and involving the most radical restructuring, do not allow BNC. I believe that this presents an argument against an analysis of BNC along the lines of the movement theory of control (MTC, Hornstein 1999, Hornstein 2003). Thematic movement would explain the licensing of the *ni*-pronoun by embedded negation. However, a movement-based theory of BNC would have to take complements most transparent for a variety of phenomena, including NC (see LDNC), to be the opaque ones for this movement. That is the opposite of what would be expected under a movement-based account. In fact, in his book Grano (2015) (which is based on the proposal in Cinque (2004)), Grano argues that PC predicates have CP complements and involve PRO-control, while exhaustive control predicates are restructuring predicates and involve thematic raising. Another general problematic point for a movement-based account is case independence: the fact that the controller NCI can bear a different case from agreeing FQs in the embedded clause (see (29)b for an example, used in Section 3.1 to argue against the NFQ analysis of BNC in OC). As an anonymous reviewer points out, case independence is extensively argued for as a problem for MTC in Bobaljik & Landau (2009). Based on these considerations, I conclude that despite its appearance Backward Negative Concord should be accounted for under a PRO-based theory of control, and as such, presents an additional argument in its favor.

Thus, I conclude that BNC is made possible through the relationship between the embedded subject (PRO) and the controller. Given the Agree-based nature of NC, I will adopt the view that control involves Agree between PRO and the controller, as proposed in Fischer (2018), McFadden & Sundaresan (2018). Syntactic analyses of obligatory control, especially in terms of Agree, famously have trouble with cases where minimal c-command doesn’t predict the choice of controller: subject control with *promise*-like verbs that involve an indirect object and control

shift. A number of proposals have been developed to amend this shortcoming (see discussion in Section 5 in Landau 2013). Although an exact solution to this shortcoming is not in the scope of this article, I posit that the facts of the BNC phenomenon, the syntactic nature of NC and BNC's close connection to control in particular, strongly suggest that control involves a dependency in the syntax which is customarily modeled via Agree (cf. Landau (2015)'s account through feature sharing under variable binding). As an anonymous reviewer points out, it follows that BNC presents an argument in favor of the view that obligatory control involves uninterpretable agreement, which, in turn, favors syntactic theories of OC over semantic ones (see the discussion of the debate in Landau 2017).

Thus the feature responsible for NC morphology gets to the controller from the embedded clause through the Agree establishing control. The main question now is how, because the controller is the goal in that Agree relationship and it is the controllee that is supposed to copy features from it. Bjorkman & Zeijlstra (2019) propose that, in Agree, checking is upward and valuation is downward. That is, if a probe on a lower DP finds T as its goal, the ϕ -probe on T can 'see' the ϕ -bundle on DP and cause it to move for the purposes of valuation. I take this a step further and propose that a probe α on an element A, where A serves as a goal in an Agree relation initiated by the probe β on an element B, can not just 'see' but also copy the relevant α feature to A. I suggest that, perhaps, this possibility is limited to (some) uninterpretable features (as opposed to ϕ -features on T). At this point, this is a stipulation, but one that is motivated by the data under consideration.

Another question is how the NC feature appears on PRO (or whatever embedded head is mediating the control relationship). One possibility is to postulate a special kind of PRO in Russian that is 'born' with this feature, which would make it an NCI-PRO. However, I do not believe this route would leave any wiggle room to restrict BNC to only a subset of control complements because NCIs are always licensed by clausemate negation in all the control complements under consideration. That means that PRO would always get the relevant morphology licensed, and since it also always has a relationship with the controller, restricting the transmission is, in this case, very difficult. It may also be undesirable to postulate PRO bearing its own NC probe, for lack of independent evidence of any kind and under the view of PRO as a minimal pronoun (Landau (2015)).

The preferable alternative then is that another element in the relevant control complement set introduces it. Given that control complements varying in (structural or featural) complexity behave differently with respect to allowing BNC (shown in Section 4), I expect this element to be a head in the functional sequence of the embedded clause. I propose that this head is C. There are a few reasons for this.

One reason is, Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023) propose exactly this kind of C for Russian obligatory control complements for reasons independent of BNC¹⁸. It is not implausible that it is available in all non-restructuring control infinitives given that LDNC is allowed into all of them. Restructuring complements expectedly allow LDNC as there is no phase boundary between the matrix and the embedded clause, and for larger control complements LDNC is mediated by C (as Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023) propose). Finite C does not seem to be able to mediate NC since LDNC is not allowed across a finite clause boundary, and I know of no language where Negative Concord dependencies can cross finite clause boundaries.

¹⁸ they, however, suggest that only for object control complements

Another reason is, as the class of control complements allowing BNC seems to be the semantic class of *Situations* in Wurmbrand & Lohninger (2023)’s terms, there is evidence of at least a TP layer, since Wurmbrand & Lohninger (2023) argue that the TMA domain is a minimal requirement for this type of clause. For object control complements in Russian, extensive literature (Lyutikova & Tatevosov 2020, Lyutikova & Gerasimova 2023 among the latest) takes them to be CPs. As for the *Situation* type subject control complements, there is no direct evidence of a C present. However, Landau (2008), McFadden & Sundaresan (2018) correlate the availability of PC with the presence of a ‘logophoric’ C in the complement structure. The availability of second dative is also correlated with infinitival CPs, and shown to be available in *Situation* type subject control complements (see Landau (2008)) with PC and indirect objects. This, at the very least, shows that the relevant matrix verbs can take infinitival CP complements.

5.3. IMPLEMENTING THE PROPOSAL. Thus, the analysis of BNC in this article contains the following ingredients argued for in the previous Section. The NC probe [Pol:_] can only probe upward. The control complements that are big enough have an NCI-like C that bears [Pol:~]. This feature gets valued under sisterhood with PolP. If it was bearing [Pol:NE], then the feature on C becomes [Pol:NE]. The [Pol:~] probe on the controller in the matrix clause can copy the NE value during the Agree relationship initiated by a probe in the embedded clause and establishing control.

One path to the implementation of this can be based on the fact that all complements that allow BNC also allow PC. McFadden & Sundaresan (2018) propose that the Agree establishing control in complements that allow PC is always mediated by C. Adopting this analysis would straightforwardly account for all cases of BNC: the C is generated with the NC feature and transmits it through the control-establishing Agree to the controller. However, this solution again doesn’t allow for enough flexibility to rule out BNC with control complements that are also big enough to include a C projection and allow PC, the Wurmbrand & Lohninger (2023)’s *Proposition* complements.

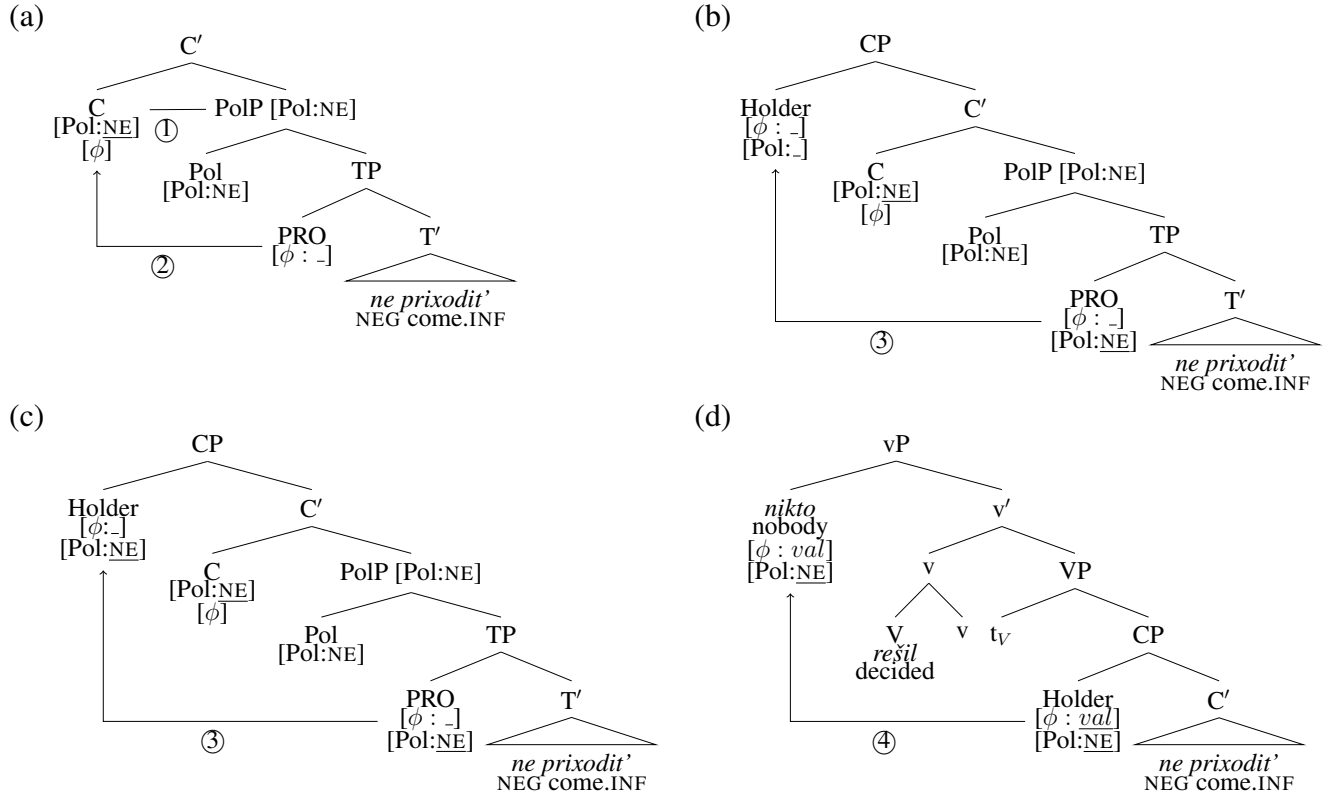
I thus propose another path. I will follow the Agree-based theory of control proposed in Fischer (2018) in assuming that PRO can establish an Agree relation with the controller, it can be moved to the left periphery of a phase (but all the way to the controller position, contra MTC Hornstein 1999) to do so. I will also assume, following Fischer (2018), that in case of an attitude predicate, the attitude holder is projected in the embedded Spec,CP (this is proposed in Landau (2015), though in that system the ϕ features get transferred through feature transmission under variable binding) and PRO agrees with the Holder. Given that the NC feature has to make its way to the controller from the embedded clause, I assume, departing in this from Fischer (2018), that the Holder and the controller also undergo Agree. To make sure that PRO gets the NC feature from C, I stipulate that the obligatory control C in Russian has a deficient ϕ -bundle¹⁹, which the ϕ probe on PRO finds, and as a result also copies the valued [Pol:NE]. This dubious step is what I suggest is behind the variation in BNC acceptability among Russian speaker(see below for discussion of variation).

In the case of an attitude control complement allowing BNC, the derivation proceeds as fol-

¹⁹ This has been proposed by Landau (2008). I, however, do not tie the interaction with the ϕ -features on C necessarily to ‘second dative’ on PRO. Though issues of case transmission are beyond the scope of this article, I speculate that the facts in Russian could receive an account along the lines of Ussery et al. (2008) or within the framework of Dependent Case Theory (see Baker 2015).

lows:

(48) Derivation of BNC with attitude control CPs of type *Situation*



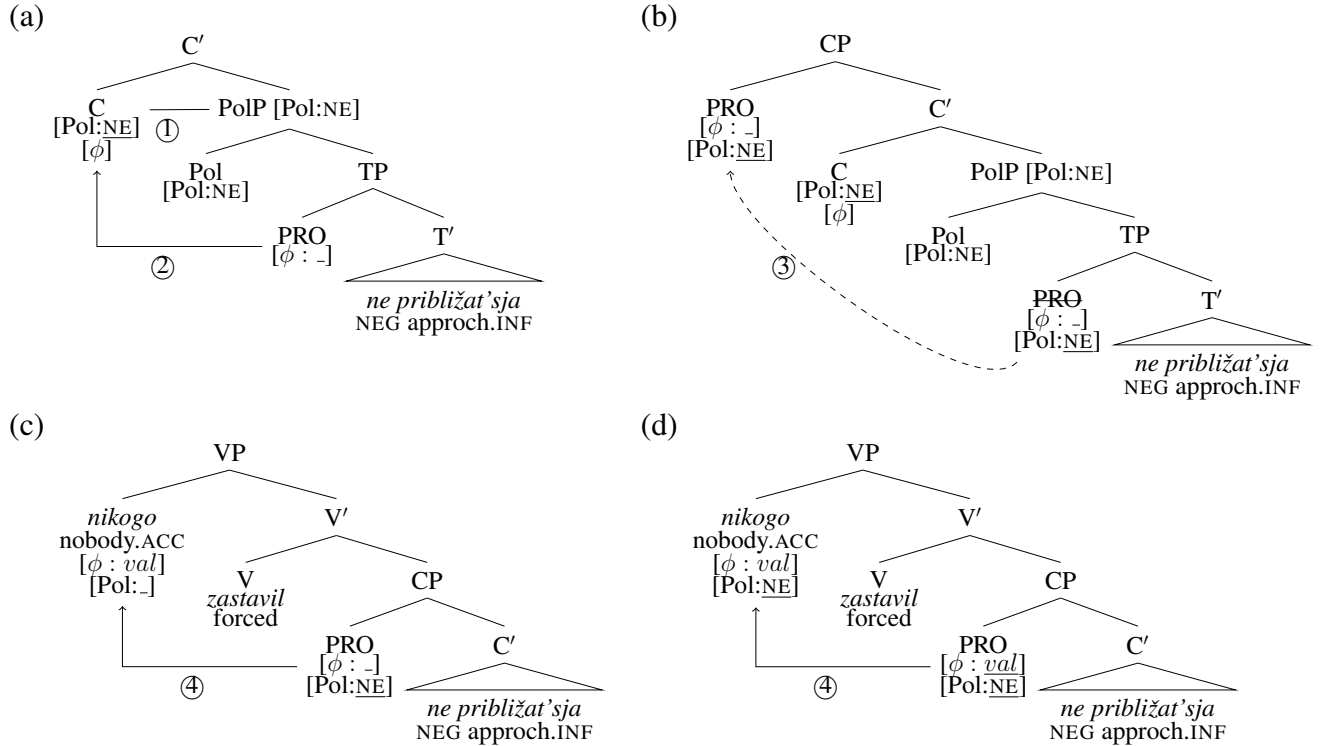
(49) Nikto rešil [ne prixodit']
 nobody.NOM decided NEG come.INF
 'Everyone decided not to come.'

The derivation in (48) proceeds as follows. After PolP is built, a complementizer bearing a [Pol:] feature is merged. This complementizer is taken to be a separate lexical item that is (optionally) available in infinitival clauses. That feature gets valued by the [Pol:NE] feature on PolP (which is projected as a feature of its head Pol) under sisterhood (①). PRO agrees with the C due to its ϕ -probe and as a reflex of that receives the valued [Pol:NE] feature from C (②). In (48)b, the attitude holder already bearing an NCI feature [Pol:] gets merged in Spec,CP. PRO keeps probing for ϕ -features, having not been satisfied with the deficient bundle on C, and enters into Agree with the attitude holder, since it also has ϕ . The [Pol:] on the Holder 'sees' the [Pol:NE] on PRO due to this Agree relation. As (48)c shows, the Holder is able to copy the NE value to its [Pol:] probe (③). The next step in (48)d is quite similar. The holder agrees with the controller NCI (④). The Holder gets the ϕ -features from the controller while the controller is able to copy the NE value to its [Pol:] probe, just like in the previous step. The ϕ -features on PRO can get valued through either the mechanism proposed in Pesetsky & Torrego (2007), in which case the ϕ -features on PRO and the Holder have become two instances of the same occurrence after Agree in ③, or the mechanism of Agree-Link and Agree-Copy proposed in Arregi & Nevins (2012), which would yield the same result here.

The derivation of BNC with attitude object control complements (of perfective conatives) is exactly parallel to (48). The only difference is that the controller is the object of the matrix clause.

I now turn to how the derivation proceeds for non-attitude implicatives. As argued for in the section above, they also map onto Wurmbrand & Lohninger (2023)’s *Situations* and involve an NCI-like C. (50) shows the derivation of BNC in (51).

(50) Derivation of BNC with non-attitude control CPs of type *Situation*

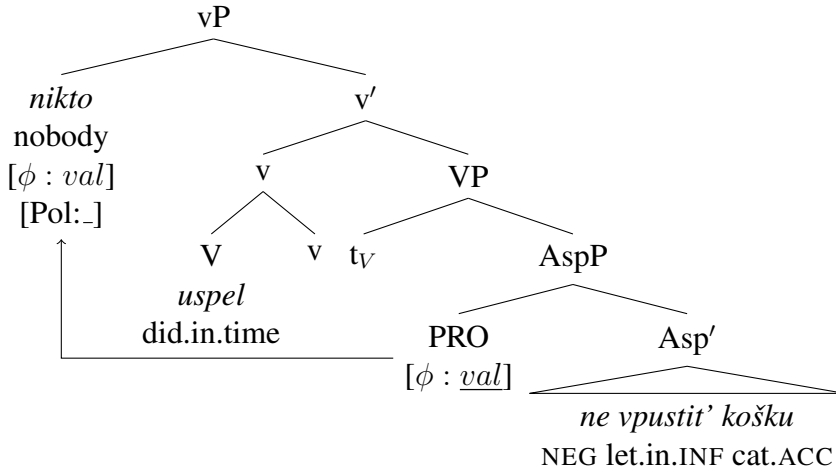


(51) *Žar zastavil nikogo ne približat'sja k nemu.*
 heat forced nobody.ACC NEG approach.INF to him
 ‘The heat made everyone not come close to him.’

The first two steps are the same as with attitude complements (50)a: after $PolP$ is built, a complementizer bearing a [Pol:-] feature is merged. That feature gets valued by the [Pol:NE] feature on $PolP$ under sisterhood (1). PRO agrees with the C due to its ϕ -probe and as a reflex of that receives the valued [Pol:NE] feature from C (2). Then, following Fischer (2018), PRO moves to Spec,CP (3 in 50b). From there it probes for the controller (50)c and, through the same mechanism as before, the NC probe on the controller is able to copy the NE feature from PRO (50)d.

Subject control implicative and aspectual predicates were shown in Section 4 to correspond to Wurmbrand & Lohninger (2023)’s *Events* and exhibit hallmarks of radical restructuring. Their complements do not have a CP-layer, and, hence, they do not exhibit BNC. In (52), I assume these complements are at least AspPs because they exhibit aspectual morphology. (52) shows an attempted derivation of the ungrammatical sentence in (53).

(52)



- (53) *Nikto uspel [ne vpustit' košku].
 nobody.NOM managed.in.time NEG let.in.INF cat
 Int.: 'Everyone managed to (close the door behind them in time to) not let the cat in.'

In case of (52), PRO never receives the feature responsible for NC morphology from C for lack of the latter. As argued for in Section 5.2, PRO cannot be introduced in the structure with that feature. PRO undergoes Agree with the controller, and the NC probe [Pol: _] on the controller never receives a value. Recall, as also argued in Section 5.2, the controller-NCI cannot probe downward on its own. One option is to say that this leads to a derivation crash, but a good alternative to say that default agreement steps in and the controller gets spelled out as a non-negative quantifier *vse* 'all'.

Now I turn to predicates from the class *ljubit'* and *ustat'* 'get.tired.of'. Section 4 established that they pattern with Wurmbrand & Lohninger (2023)'s *Propositions* which are argued to have as a requirement a CP domain. Wurmbrand & Lohninger (2023) propose that the three general classes they observe form an implicational hierarchy through syntactic containment. It would follow that the complements of these predicates are more structurally are featurally complex than *Situations* and even more so *Events*. This coupled with the analysis that is being developed so far allows for two possibilities to account for these predicates not allowing BNC. One is to stipulate that the C involved in these complements is featurally different. LDNC is still possible with complements of these factives, so stipulating no [Pol: _] is out of the question. What can be stipulated is that the C involved in *Proposition*-type complements lacks the ϕ -bundle that 'attracts' PRO to agree with C and get the NC feature. Another route is to appeal to the larger structural complexity of *Proposition*-type complements. C is able to value its [Pol: _] under sisterhood with PolP. However, if the relevant C head for *Proposition*-type complements is higher in the structure, this opportunity disappears. Thus, the NE value will never get to C, and, hence, to PRO, and, hence, to the controller.

Summing up, I propose here that under a limited type of circumstances, only with features uninterpretable on the probe, a feature value can be copied from a probe to a goal. That is how it gets from PRO to the controller or the attitude holder and then the controller. This proposal is also inspired by the analysis of NC in Deal (2021) and the discussion of the mechanisms of

Agree in Deal (2022), where the author explores the mechanism of how a probe can ‘flag’ its goal with a feature. The proposal also involves a few stipulations. Firstly, though it has been proposed before in relation to second dative assignment (Landau 2008), the presence of a ϕ -bundle on OC C (at least in *Situations*) is rather arbitrary, since I am specifically remaining agnostic here about the dative assignment mechanism. Secondly, the other stipulation is that PRO can get a feature it didn’t probe for from C. The idea that Agree is coarse and the probe copies all it can get is not new (see, for example, Baker 2008 for the idea that all functional heads agree with whatever features they can find). To the best of my knowledge, however, this is usually stated of ϕ -agreement. Here I stipulate this of at least one more kind of feature, the NC kind.

5.4. DISCUSSION OF VARIATION. At this point it is possible to speculate on the points of divergence within Russian speakers with respect to BNC structures. The examples judged and reported grammatical for this paper are not uniformly accepted by Russian speakers. I suggest that this could be due to two potentially dubious points necessary for the derivation of BNC. Firstly, I suggest that PRO being able to copy [Pol:NE] from C under Agree without having the Pol feature before the Agree was established could not be a universally shared mechanism. Secondly, the main mechanism under which a feature on a goal can be valued by a probe may not be commonly shared.

There seem to be multiple factors impacting BNC acceptability that still require further exploration. These may also impact the variation within speakers in general accepting BNC structures. An anonymous reviewer reports finding the BNC structure with *xotet* ‘want’ ungrammatical. The immediate property in that it differs from other predicates here is its Neg-raising nature. It seems pragmatically odd in many cases to pronounce negation in the embedded clause of *want* without extra factors (such as contrast) conditioning it. This may indicate that pragmatic factors could be a source of variability for these structures. Another factor that is potentially relevant for further exploration of the BNC phenomenon is matrix aspect. The aspect of the matrix clause seems to, at least in certain cases, impact the BNC grammaticality. An anonymous reviewer points out that at least with *try*-class predicates BNC is possible with imperfective matrix predicate but ungrammatical with perfective aspect in the matrix clause. This could be due to the unique aspectual nature of *try*-predicates discussed in Section 8 based on Grano (2017). However, if this spans beyond *try*-class predicates, and given the relationship that negation has been reported to have with aspect (Matthews 1990), this could indicate semantic restrictions relevant for BNC.

Another point of bifurcation seems to appear with implicative object control. Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020) report that these complements allow NCIs in surface object position, and allow split and partial control, which then makes the prediction, following Landau (2015), that they would be ‘tensed’, which is borne out for the speakers consulted for this article, who also accept BNC with implicative object control. However, Landau (2015) classifies these as predicative control and Burukina (2020) reports BNC not being grammatical for these. I suggest, following the findings in Section 4, that the availability of PC and conflicting temporal modification is correlated with the availability of BNC. For Russian speakers that allow PC and conflicting temporal modification with implicative OC complements, they pattern with Wurmbrand & Lohninger (2023)’s *Situations*, and, as the rest of the class, would be expected to allow BNC. For the Russian speakers that do not allow PC and conflicting temporal modification with implicative OC complements, they pattern with *Events* and would be expected to not allow BNC.

6. Predictions. A prediction can be inferred based on the crucial part the NC feature on C plays in deriving BNC. Recall, that some predicates with ‘negative’ meaning have been argued to select for negative complementizers (Laka 1992, Progovac 1993b, Landau 2002). The main kind of evidence for such negative complementizers comes from licensing NPIs in clausal complements of such verbs together with the unavailability of such licensing in their nominal complements. Such control predicates should not be able to license Backward Negative Concord, since the complementizer in their complement has to bear a different [Pol:neg]²⁰ feature, one that doesn’t partake in NC licensing (see (46) for evidence), and, hence, cannot smuggle a [Pol: NE] feature to the controller.

Indeed, this has been noted in Kholodilova (2015). For instance, take *otkazat’sja* ‘to refuse’ and *otgovorit’* ‘to talk out of’. BNC is allowed with their ‘positive’ counterparts *soglasit’sja* ‘to agree’ (54) and *ugovorit’* ‘to talk into’ (55).

- (54) Context: at a meeting, there was a discussion of a potential problem. The members decided to worry about it later.

Nikto soglasilsja [poka ob etom **ne** zamoračivat’sja].
nobody.NOM agreed for.now about this NEG worry.INF
‘Everyone agreed to not worry about it for now.’

- (55) Ravvin ugovoril **nikogo** [**ne** vyxodit’ iz zala].
rabbi talked.into nobody.ACC NEG exit.INF from hall
‘The rabbi talked everyone into not leaving the hall.’

It is, however, disallowed with the ‘negative’ predicates.

- (56) ***Nikto** otkazalsja [**ne** obraščat’ na eto vnimanija].
nobody.NOM refused NEG turn.INF on this attention
Int.: ‘Everyone refused to ignore this. (=not pay attention to it)’

- (57) *Ravvin otgovoril **nikogo** [**ne** vyxodit’ iz zala].
rabbi talked.out.of nobody.ACC NEG exit.INF from hall
Int.: ‘The rabbi talked everyone out of not leaving the hall.’

Thus, the current analysis provides a straightforward way to account for Kholodilova (2015)’s observation.

Since this analysis assigns the responsibility for BNC licensing to the same NC complementizer that mediates long-distance negative concord, the prediction is that in case long-distance negative concord is not possible, Backward Negative Concord should also be out. Another complement control structure that this can be tested against is a *wh*-infinitival. Long-distance NC turns out to be unavailable for control into *wh*-infinitives (58).

²⁰ I dub the polarity feature value corresponding to a negative operator not related to *ne*-negation in Russian as just *neg* here.

- (58) *Ja **ne** znaju [kak **nikogo** poprosit' o pomošči].
 I NEG know how nobody.ACC ask.INF about help
 Int.: 'I don't know how to ask anyone for help.'

This unavailability can be surprising given that infinitival *wh*-complements also exhibit obligatory control and Russian seems to have the NCI-C associated with OC. Given Erschler (2023)'s proposal that NCIs need to be licensed both syntactically and semantically, one could imagine this restriction being semantic. It doesn't seem to be the case here, given that an NPI is licensed in the same position:

- (59) Ja **ne** znaju [kak čto-libo delat'].
 I NEG know how what.ACC-NPI do.INF
 'I don't know how to do anything.'

For the purposes of the predictions of the current analysis, I focus on the fact that (58)–(59) suggest that in these structures [Pol: _] is unavailable on C. At this time, I can only speculate that it may have to do with the interplay between polarity and interrogative force. Expectedly, Backward Negative Concord is also not possible in these structures.

- (60) ***Nikto** znajet [kak **ne** svintit'sja]
 nobody knows how NEG screw.INF
 Int.: 'Everyone knows how not to get detained.'

Another fact worth noting here is that negative floating quantifiers can also be licensed if 'floated' by the controller. This is expected at least under the stranding analysis of these elements (see Tiskin (2016) for arguments for such an analysis for Russian NFQs).

- (61) Rebjata nikto rešili ne prixodit'.
 Guys.NOM nobody.NOM decided NEG come.INF
 'The guys all (of them) decided not to come.'

In sum, the current proposal is able to account for the contrast between negative and positive predicates with respect to BNC licensing and correctly predicts unavailability of BNC with other CP control complements that disallow LDNC.

Parallel to predictions for Russian, the proposal restricts the pool of languages that could potentially exhibit BNC to those that have LDNC with predicates higher than *Events* on the implicational hierarchy in Wurmbrand & Lohninger (2023). Given that some NC languages only allow LDNC with radical restructuring (Italian, Grano 2015, Greek, Giannakidou & Quer 1997, BCMS, Progovac 1993a), this does narrow the potential list down, but not sufficiently: as an anonymous reviewer reports, in Hebrew, LDNC is possible with a *Situation*-embedding predicate like *promise*, but BNC is still disallowed. The underlying cause could be similar to what disallows BNC in Russian *Proposition*-type complements: they are too big to allow it.

7. Interpretation of NCIs. The analysis proposed in this paper views the NCIs as underlying universal quantifiers based on the fact that BNC structures can only receive interpretation in (i), and not one in (ii).

- (62) Nikto rešil [ne prixodit']
 nobody.NOM decided NEG come.INF
 i. ‘Everyone decided not to come.’
 ii. * ‘Someone decided not to come’

This follows the general view argued for in Zeijlstra 2004, Zeijlstra 2008 that NCIs are not semantically negative. It does, however, clash with the common view of Negative Concord items as indefinites interpreted under negation (Laka 1990, Ladusaw 1992, Zeijlstra 2004, Zeijlstra 2008, Gajic 2016).²¹ The view of Negative Concord Items as universal quantifiers scoping over negation has also been extensively argued for (Giannakidou 2000, Abels 2005, Shimoyama 2011, Rossyaykin 2022). In fact, Rossyaykin 2022 mentions BNC structures as one of the arguments in favor of the universal quantificational force of (Russian) NCIs.

The difficulty in distinguishing between the existential and universal quantification force in negative environments stems from the equivalence $\forall x. \neg P(x) \iff \neg \exists x. P(x)$. Gajic 2016 reproduces split scope diagnostics employed by Shimoyama 2011, Zeijlstra 2011 to disambiguate between the narrow-scope existential and wide-scope universal NCI readings in Serbo-Croatian. One way of splitting negation from the NCI quantifier used in Shimoyama 2011, Gajic 2016 is using a quantification adverb that always scopes above negation. Such an adverbial in Russian is *v osnovnom* ‘mostly’. In the context with *ni*-phrases, the reading $\forall > Q_{adv} > \neg$ is available with subject *ni*-phrases (63), but not with object *ni*-phrases (64).

- (63) Ni odin student/ nikto v.osnovnom ne poseščal pary
 not one student/ nobody mostly NEG attended class
 i. ‘On most days, no student came to class.’ $Q_{adv} > \neg \exists / \forall \neg$
 ii. ‘For every student, that student didn’t come to class on most days.’ $\forall > Q_{adv} > \neg$
- (64) Doktor v.osnovnom ne prinimal ni odnogo pacienta/ nikogo.
 doctor mostly NEG examine not one.ACC patient.ACC nobody.ACC
 i. ‘On most days, the doctor didn’t examine anyone.’ $Q_{adv} > \neg \exists / \forall \neg$
 ii. *‘For every patient, that patient didn’t come to the doctor on most days.’ $\forall > Q_{adv} > \neg$

This is parallel to the results reported in Gajic 2016 for Serbo-Croatian. Based on the fact that other diagnostics show the availability of existential reading for Serbo-Croatian NCIs, Gajic 2016 claims that the availability of the universal reading in (63) is only a wide-scope illusion resulting from the positive polarity nature of the adverb and information structure. I propose a different route: the universal force is available for NCIs. Its unavailability in (64) may not have to do with negative concord at all, since the (ii) reading is still not available even with a non-negative universal quantifier in the object position. Whatever stops the universal quantifier from scoping over the quantificational adverb in (65), seems to prevent it in (64) as well.

²¹ I thank Hedde Zeijlstra for this observation.

- (65) Doktor v.osnovnom ne prinal vse pacientov.
 doctor mostly NEG examine all.ACC patients
 i. ‘On most days, the doctor didn’t examine all of the patients.’ $Q_{adv} > \neg\forall$ or $Q_{adv} > \forall\neg$
 ii. *‘For every patient, that patient didn’t come to the doctor on most days.’ $\forall > Q_{adv} > \neg$

Another scoping element that can be ‘inserted’ between the negation and the NCI is a modal (Zeijlstra 2011, Gajic 2016). In this case, if the modal scopes under negation, it can give rise to a reading in (66) where the modal is interpreted under the negation and above the existential.

- (66) Nikto (iz studentov) ne dolžen idti peškom. (Vse mogut jexat’ v lifte.)
 nobody of students NEG must go.INF on.foot (all can ride in elevator)
 ii. ‘It is not required that any student take the stairs.’ $\neg > must > \exists$
 (Everyone can take the elevator.)

Based on the facts presented in this section, I put forward the possibility that both wide-scope universal and narrow-scope existential interpretations are available for NCIs in Russian. In that I follow Giannakidou 2000, who reports two paradigms for NCIs in Greek: non-emphatic (existential) and emphatic (universal). Similar two paradigms have been reported for Hungarian (Surányi 2006). Among other distributional facts, Giannakidou 2000 uses modification by ‘almost’ to be diagnostic of universal quantification force of the emphatic neg-phrases in Greek. In fact, if the *ni*-phrase in (66) is modified by *počti* ‘almost’, the existential reading $\neg > must > \exists$ disappears.

Given the operational NC model in this paper (laid out in Section 5.1), this can be implemented in the following way. Both universals and existentials are pronounced as NCIs if they have received a feature as a result of interacting with negation. In Zeijlstra’s system that feature is [*u*NEG] checked against negation, in the current article’s system it is [Pol:NE]. That would mean that QPs are always ‘born’ with this Pol probe. If Agree doesn’t value it with NE, the QPs are spelled out as non-negative.²² The narrow-scope requirement for existential NCIs can be explained by the requirement of semantic licensing of the underlying NPI that is proposed in Erschler (2023). As for the wide-scope requirement for universals, Giannakidou 2000 proposes that they necessarily undergo QR. The necessary nature of this QR remains for further investigation.

To summarize, in this section I conclude that universal quantificational force is available for Russian NCIs and put forth a possibility that it coexists with the availability of existential force. Universals that have a [Pol:NE] feature and are above negation at LF can be pronounced as NCIs. That is exactly what can be seen in Backward Negative Concord structures.

8. Try-class predicates. In this Section, I discuss Backward Negative Concord with *try*-class predicates. Firstly, I argue that *try*-class predicates are not like other predicates that are classified as restructuring predicates. Secondly, I show that BNC is possible with *try*-predicates and propose that the mechanism behind it is the same as the rest of subject control BNC discussed in Section 5.

²² This has a good potential to derive the Bagel Problem (Pereltsvaig 2004), since NPIs would automatically become NCIs in the scope of clausemate negation. There are, however, contexts in which both an NCI and an NPI are possible, which poses a potential problem. The detailed account of the Bagel Problem is not in the scope of the current paper.

8.1. STATUS. *Try*-class predicates are typically classified as restructuring predicates (Wurmbrand 2001). Indeed, *try*-class predicates in Russian, like aspectual and implicative subject control predicates are, in Landau’s terms, semantically tenseless: do not allow conflicting temporal modification.

Landau (2015) classifies *try*-class as nonattitude and, hence, semantically untensed exhaustive control predicates. Building on the work in Sharvit (2003) and Grano (2011), Grano (2017) proposes an analysis of *try* treating it as an unusual aspectual kind of propositional attitude predicate. The denotation he proposes for *John tried to open the door* in Grano 2017:10 is shown in (67).

- (67) $\exists e[Ag(e, j) \wedge \forall w' \in INT_{j,w} : \exists e'[e \subset_{init} e' \wedge open(e') \wedge Ag(e', j) \wedge Th(e', d) \text{ in } w']]$
 $\approx$ ‘There is some event e whose agent is John and all worlds compatible with John’s intentions in w are worlds in which e is an initial stage of some event e' which is an opening event whose agent is John and whose theme is the door’

Under these semantics, the conflicting temporal modification of the matrix event e and the intended outcome e' would lead to a contradiction because e is in a part-whole relationship with e' .

Under Landau (2015)’s view, this suggests that *try*-class predicates’ complements may be more structurally complex. Wurmbrand & Lohninger (2023) also note that *try*-complements tend to be the in-between case cross-linguistically, showing both properties of Events and *Situations*. I believe there are three facts about Russian *try*-predicates that point to that conclusion.

Firstly, the only diagnostic for restructuring that can be implemented in Russian is the one having to do with embedded temporal reference. However, the unavailability of conflicting temporal modification does not definitively signal the absence of a TP layer altogether. As shown by Grano, this unavailability may be the result of a contradiction due to the special semantics of *try*.

Secondly, unlike other restructuring predicates, *try*-predicates in Russian do not restrict the embedded aspect no matter the matrix aspect.

Both perfective and imperfective *try*-predicates can have either perfective or imperfective verbs in their complement (see (68) for illustration with imperfective). Concerning this, *try*-complements pattern with *Situation*-type complements..

- (68) Katja staralas’ čitat’/ pročitat’ Brat’ev Karamazovyx (k Ponedel’niku).
 Katya tried.IPV read.IPV.INF read.PFV.INF Brothers Karamazov (by Monday)
 ‘Katya tried to read Brothers Karamazov (by Monday).’

Finally, unlike other restructuring predicates, *try*-predicates sometimes allow PC readings.

- (69) Mama_i staralas’ [PRO_{i+} (vsegda) užinat’ vmeste].
 mom tried (always) have.dinner.INF together
 ‘Mom tried to always have dinner together (as a family).’

Based on the attitudinal semantics for *try* proposed in Grano (2017), the marginal acceptability of PC, the lack of definitive language-internal restructuring diagnostics for Russian (i.e. clitic climbing), and the fact that *try*-complements pattern with other *Situation*-type complements with respect to aspect restrictions, I conclude that *try*-predicate complements in Russian can potentially be CPs.

8.2. BNC WITH *try*-PREDICATES. I suggest that, given their patterning with Situation complements, *try*-predicates do involve a CP-layer responsible for encoding the embedded attitude coordinates. That explains the fact that *try*-predicates allow Backward Negative Concord.²³

- (70) **Nikto** staralsja/ pytal'sja [ob etom **ne** dumat'].
 nobody.NOM tried/ attempted about this NEG think.sc inf
 'Everyone tried not to think about it.'

Under the restructuring analysis of *try*, it could be suggested that the restructuring nature of *try*-predicates allows for NCIs to be licensed in the matrix clause since the structure is actually monoclausal and, hence, contains a clausemate negation. In the following part of this Section, I show that this is not the case because the only position in which a *ni*-pronoun is licensed is still the subject – the controller.

A way to demonstrate that NCIs can only be subjects is to use 'x times' modification in both matrix and embedded clause.²⁴ In (71)b, the NCI *ni razu* 'not once' can only be interpreted in the embedded clause which contains conflicting modification *dvaždy* 'twice'. The sentence turns out to be nonsensical, unless one can reconceptualize the second adjunct to be interpreted in the main clause, which would yield something like *On two occasions, Olya tried not to hit the target even once*. This reading, however, is very marginal with the given word order.

- (71) a. Olya pjat' raz pytalas' popast' v mišen' dvaždy.
 Olya five times tried get.INF in target twice
 'Olya tried five times to hit the target twice.'
- b. ??Olya **ni razu** pytalas' ne popast' v mišen' dvaždy.
 Olya NCI times tried NEG get.INF in target twice
 Int.: 'Olya tried every time not to hit the target twice.'

Considering (i.) Grano (2017)'s analysis of *try*-predicates; (ii.) Wurmbrand & Lohninger (2023)'s classification of *try*-class predicates as borderline between *Events* and *Situations*; (iii.) *try*-predicates patterning with *Situations* concerning aspect restrictions; (iv.) the fact that, like in

²³ There is one predicate of the *try*-class that is degraded with BNC: *probovat* 'to try/attempt'.

- (i) ??Nikto proboval [ob etom ne dumat].
 nobody.NOM attempted about it NEG think.sc inf
 Int.: 'Everyone attempted not to think about it.'

This predicate shares the properties of *try*-class predicates concerning temporal modification and aspectual restrictions: embedded clause cannot admit conflicting temporal modifiers but can have either perfective or imperfective aspect independent of the matrix aspect. One difference between *probovat* and the other *try*-class predicates is that it is the only one that can take a DP complement and express the meaning in (ii)–(iii).

- (ii) Ira poprobovala/ *postaralas' novyj kofe.
 Ira tried/ tried new coffee
 'Ira tried a new coffee.'
- (iii) Olja probovala [katat'sja na lyžax].
 Olya tried ride.INF on skis
 'Olya has tried skiing. (=has the experience)'

So far it remains unclear what specific difference is behind this predicate's anomalous behavior with respect to BNC.

²⁴ I thank an anonymous reviewer for making this suggestion.

other BNC cases, NCIs are only licensed by embedded negation in the subject (controller) position of *try*-predicates, I conclude that the analysis proposed in Section 5 can be extended to Backward Negative Concord with *try*-predicates. That is, a C with [Pol:_] introduces it into the structure and values with NE under sisterhood with PolP. PRO gets the feature as the result of Agree (which it undergoes due to the ϕ -bundle on C) and the controller is able to value its [Pol:_] from the [PolP:NE] on PRO, thus licensing the controller NCI.

9. Backward Negative Concord with Raising. Russian is typically not considered among languages attesting Raising to Subject from infinitivals. There are, however, some predicates exhibiting properties typical of raising. Raising to subject should be able to produce Backward Negative Concord-like structures parallel to the ones discussed in this article. Indeed, if the NCI originates in the embedded clause that has negation, the [Pol:_] feature can be valued with NE before the NCI moves to the matrix clause. This section provides two examples of what I consider to be raising predicates in Russian and BNC structures with them.

Minor (2013) uses the licensing of *-nibud'* pronouns which can only be licensed in non-veridical contexts as one of the tests for embedded interpretation of the controller in object control structures. There are at least two subject control verbs that pass this test.²⁵ One such verb is *obeščat* 'promise': even though it can act as a regular subject control predicate and assign a theta role to its subject, there seems to be a raising version of this predicate. (72)a shows that *nibud'*-pronouns can be licensed in the subject of *obeščat* 'promise', (72)b shows that it is not possible in the absence of an embedded infinitive, (72)c shows that the pronoun can be licensed in the embedded clause. Following Minor (2013), Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020), I take that to mean that the subject is interpreted in the embedded clause – reconstruction typical for raising.

- (72) a. Kto-**nibud'** obeščal [pomoč].
 who-nibud' promised help.INF
 'Someone or other promised to help.'
- b. *Kto-**nibud'** obeščal grozu.
 who-nibud' promised storm
 Int.: 'Someone or other promised a storm.'
- c. Vera obeščala [kogo-**nibud'** ubit'].
 Vera promised who-nibud' kill.INF
 'Vera promised to kill someone or other.'

Another subject control verb exhibiting this kind of dual behavior is *riskovat* 'risk'. (73) shows a parallel paradigm with *nibud'* pronouns for *riskovat* 'risk' as is shown above for *obeščat* 'promise'.

- (73) a. Kto-**nibud'** riskuet [upast].
 who-nibud' risks fall.INF
 'Someone or other risks falling.'
- b. *Kto-**nibud'** riskuet svoimi denigami.
 who-nibud' risks REFL money.INST
 Int.: 'Someone or other is risking their own money.'

²⁵ I thank Sergei Minor for sharing this observation.

- c. Vera riskuet [kogo-**nibud'** ubit'].
 Vera risks who-nubud' kill.INF
 'Vera risks killing someone or other.'

Other properties indicating the raising nature of constructions with these two verbs are the following. The possibility of an inanimate subject shows the lack of selectional restrictions on the subject (74). Idiomatic reading can be preserved (76). No change to truth conditions under passive is shown in (77)–(78).

- (74) a. ...metodika obeščæt [pomoč za dve nedeli].
 method promises help.INF in 2 weeks
 '...method promises to help in 2 weeks'
- b. ...metodika riskuet [navredit'].
 method promises harm.INF
 '...method risks doing harm'

The idioms used for this are the following (75). The idiom in (75)a is an idiomatic expression that constitutes a whole sentence. It was chosen for *obeščæt* 'promise' over the idiom in (75) to keep the subject inanimate since this verb seems to alternate between control and raising based on the animacy of the subject.

- (75) a. Larčik prosto odkryvalsja
 casket easily open.INF
 Idiom.: 'The solution was simple (despite expectations).'
 Lit.: 'The casket opened easily.'
- b. Ego žaba dušit.
 he.ACC toad strangles
 Idiom.: 'He is (getting) greedy.'
 Lit.: 'A toad is strangling him.'
- (76) a. Larčik obeščæt prosto odkryt'sja.
 casket promised easily open.INF
 'The solution promised to be easy.'
- b. Ego žaba riskuet zadušit'.
 he.ACC toad risks strangle.INF
 'There is a risk of him getting too greedy.'
- (77) a. Dožd' obeščæt zamedlit' trafik.
 rain promises slow.down.INF traffic
 'It looks like rain is going to slow down traffic.'
- b. Trafik obeščæt byt' zamedlen dožd-em.
 traffic promises be.INF slowed.down rain-INSTR
 'It looks like traffic is going to be slowed down by rain.' (77)a=(77)

- (78) a. Dožd' riskuet zamedlit' trafik.
rain risks slow.down.INF traffic
'There is a risk that rain is going to slow down traffic.'
- b. Trafik riskuet byt' zamedlen dožd-em.
traffic risks be.INF slowed.down rain-INTR
'There is a risk that traffic is going to be slowed down by rain.' (78)a=(78)

As can be predicted, Backward Negative Concord is possible with the raising readings of *obeščat* 'promise', *riskovat* 'risk'.

- (79) a. Ničego obeščает ne vyjti.
nothing promises NEG work.out.INF
'It looks like nothing is going to work out.'
- b. Ničego riskuet ne vyjti.
nothing risks NEG work.out.INF
'There is a risk that nothing is going to work out.'

- (80) from [Forum](#)
Na ego koncert nikto riskuet ne pojti.
on his concert nobody risks NEG go.INF
'There is a risk that nobody will come to his concert.'

Importantly, these examples differ from BNC with control verbs in the interpretation of the NCI subject. While with control the NCI is interpreted as a universal quantifier in the matrix clause (and, hence, above negation), the NCIs in (79)–(80) are interpreted in the embedded clause. When an NCI is interpreted with local negation, the narrow-scope existential and wide-scope universal readings are equivalent.

10. Conclusion. In this article, I have shown that as the result of the control relationship established between the embedded clause and the controller, a feature licensing NC can be transmitted to the controller, resulting in what I call backward negative concord. Following Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023), I propose that the element responsible for the introduction of that feature in the embedded structure is a special NC complementizer. Thus, control predicates with complements big enough to include C (but not too big, see factives and *wh*-complements) allow backward negative concord. Given this generalization, I argued against a movement-based account of BNC (and, hence, control in general). This article also argues in favor of the idea that valuation under Agree can, under constrained circumstances, be transitive (compare to the implementation in Deal 2022). As a result, features can not only be transmitted from the controller to PRO but an NC probe on the controller can copy a value from PRO as a by-product of the established Agree.

The proposed analysis views BNC as a syntactic phenomenon that becomes possible due to the interaction of (i) the availability of a special kind of complementizer C which bears a feature responsible for NCI morphology; (ii) the relationship between C and PRO that allows for transfer of that feature to PRO; (iii) the transitive feature valuation under the Agree relationship established between the controller and the null subject element in the infinitival complement. Another direct consequence, besides disfavoring MTC, that this proposal has for the theory of control is

that it concludes control must involve uninterpretable agreement. This is favoring syntactic theories of control over purely semantic ones.

Another theory that this article's results are relevant for the view analyzing control in restructuring predicates as thematic raising (Cinque 2004, Grano 2015). The data in this article contradict this analysis: it is exactly the restructuring predicates that do not allow backward negative concord licensing. That is unexpected on the view that the controller in such structures originated in a position with local negation. A possible way of reconciling BNC and restructuring control as thematic raising could come from the view that θ -raising, unlike A-raising, cannot reconstruct at LF (Hornstein (1999)). Data in the Section 9 shows that A-raising of *ni*-pronouns out of negated infinitives is grammatical and the *ni*-pronoun in such contexts (necessarily) reconstructs in the embedded clause. Data in Section 2.3 also show that *ni*-phrases can be scrambled out of negated infinitives into the main clause. They, of course, also reconstruct in the embedded clause. It is possible that movement only licenses BNC if it reconstructs in the embedded clause at LF. The nature of this potential restriction remains for further investigation. Such an account, however, would get rid of the advantage a movement-based theory has for accounting for BNC, namely, the possibility of licensing the matrix NCI in the embedded clause.

Appendix. For reasons of space, the main body of the paper only has a few examples to illustrate the division among predicates into those that allow BNC and those that do not. In this appendix, I provide additional examples to provide further illustration.

SUBJECT CONTROL. Situation type complements (attitude):

- (81) Context: The committee decided to prolong the meeting a little more and discuss the last action item, because:

(V sledujuščij raz) **nikto** bojalsja [ob etom **ne** vspomnit'].
 in next time nobody.NOM feared about this NEG remember.INF
 'Everyone was afraid of not remembering about this (next time).'

- (82) (Russian National Corpus)

...**nikto** predpočitaet [**ne** vspominat' [čto nyněšnj den' zaščitnika
 nobody.NOM prefers NEG recall.INF that today's day defender.GEN
 otečestva <...>]]
 fatherland.GEN
 'Everyone prefers to not recall that today's Defender of the Fatherland day...<...>'

- (83) Context: At a business meeting, there was a discussion of a potential problem that everyone decided to set aside for now.

Nikto soglasilsja [poka ob etom **ne** zamoračivat'sja].
 nobody.NOM yet about it NEG bother.INF
 'Everyone agreed not to bother thinking about it for now.'

- (84) **Nikto** planiruet/ sobiraetsja [**ne** prijt].
 nobody.NOM plans/ intends NEG come.INF
 'Everyone plans/intends to not come.'

Speakers seem to disagree on whether BNC with *xotet* ‘to want’ is acceptable. One potential confound to be considered here is that it is a Neg-raising verb, which could be interacting with the phenomenon. Exactly how is left to further research at this point. One potentially relevant observation, however, is that overt negation in the embedded clause seems awkward or marked with *xotet* even without BNC.

(85) ?**Nikto** xotel [ne obraščat’ na eto vnimanija].
nobody.NOM wanted NEG turn.INF on this attention
‘Everyone wanted not to pay attention to this (=to ignore)’

(86) **Nikto** obeščal [ne napivat’sja]
nobody.NOM promised NEG get.drunk.INF
‘Everyone promised not to get drunk.’

(87) Context: The meeting is running very late, the last train into the city is leaving soon. Unless the meeting ends right now,
Nikto riskuet [ne uspet’ na poezd].
nobody.NOM risks NEG manage.in.time.INF on train
‘Everyone is risking missing the train.’

OBJECT CONTROL. Conatives:

- (88) a. from www.ntv.ru
Ravvin ubedil **nikogo** ne vyxodit’ iz zala.
rabbi persuaded.PFV nobody.ACC NEG exit.INF from hall
‘The rabbi persuaded everyone not to leave the hall.’
b. Vrač ubeždal **nikogo** ne privivat’sja.
doctor persuaded.IPV nobody.ACC NEG get.vaccinated.INF
‘The doctor tried to persuade everyone not to get vaccinated.’

Others:²⁶

- (89) Context: Petya is not a morning person and isn’t ready to communicate until after breakfast.
Petja naučil **nikogo** [ne približat’sja k nemu do zavtraka].
Petya taught nobody.ACC NEG approach.INF to him before breakfast
‘Petya taught everyone not to approach him before breakfast.’

²⁶ An anonymous reviewer points out that the examples in this section are only marginally acceptable. While the author and the consulted speakers agree that they are somewhat awkward and certainly less than perfect, they are considerably better than the unacceptable examples for subject control BNC. Thus, I consider them worth examining along the other cases presented in the paper. It seems, like with the other successful BNC cases, that there is a dialectal split within Russian speakers with regards to the acceptability of BNC structures.

- (90) Context: The locker room where kids usually store bags will be undergoing renovation over the weekend.
 Učitel' napomnil **nikomu** [ne ostavljat' sumki v razdevalke].
 teacher reminded nobody.DAT NEG leave.INF bags in locker.room
 'The teacher reminded everyone not to leave their bags in the locker room.'
- (91) Trener predupredil **nikogo** [ne prinimat' steroidy nakožnym sposobom].
 coach warned nobody.ACC NEG take.INF steroids cutaneous method
 'The coach warned everybody not to apply steroids cutaneously.'

References

- Abels, Klaus. 2005. "Expletive negation" in Russian: A conspiracy theory. *Journal of Slavic linguistics* 5–74.
- Arregi, Karlos & Andrew Nevins. 2012. *Morphotactics: Basque auxiliaries and the structure of spellout*, vol. 86. Springer Science & Business Media.
- Babby, Leonard H. 1998. Subject control as direct predication: Evidence from Russian. In *Proceedings of the 6th meeting of formal approaches to slavic linguistics*, 17–37. Michigan Slavic Publications, Michigan University Ann Arbor.
- Bailyn, John F. 2012. *The syntax of Russian*. Cambridge University Press.
- Bailyn, John Frederick. 2001. The syntax of slavic predicate case. *ZAS papers in linguistics* 22. 1–23.
- Baker, Mark. 2015. *Case 146*. Cambridge University Press.
- Baker, Mark C. 2008. *The syntax of agreement and concord*, vol. 115. Cambridge University Press.
- Bjorkman, Bronwyn M & Hedde Zeijlstra. 2019. Checking up on (ϕ -) agree. *Linguistic inquiry* 50(3). 527–569.
- Bobaljik, Jonathan David & Idan Landau. 2009. Icelandic control is not A-movement: The case from case. *Linguistic inquiry* 40(1). 113–132.
- Brown, Sue & Steven Franks. 1995. Asymmetries in the scope of Russian negation. *Journal of Slavic linguistics* 239–287.
- Burukina, Irina. 2020. Mandative verbs and deontic modals in Russian: Between obligatory control and overt embedded subjects. *Glossa: a journal of general linguistics* 5(1).
- Cinque, Guglielmo. 2004. Restructuring and functional structure. *The cartography of syntactic structures* 3. 132–191.
- Clem, Emily & Amy Rose Deal. 2024. Dependent case by agree: Ergative in Shawi. *Linguistic Inquiry* 1–75.
- Comrie, Bernard. 1974. The second dative: A transformational approach. *Slavic transformational syntax* 10. 123–150.
- Deal, Amy Rose. 2021. Negative concord as downward agree. *Unpublished manuscript*.
- Deal, Amy Rose. 2022. Current models of Agree. *Manuscript. UC Berkeley*.
- Erschler, David. 2023. Colloquial emphatic negation in Russian and morphology of negative concord. *Journal of Slavic Linguistics* 31(FASL 30 issue). 1–18.
- Fischer, Silke. 2018. Locality, control, and non-adjoined islands. *Glossa: a journal of general linguistics* 3(1).

- Gajic, Jovana. 2016. N-words and the wide scope illusion. In *33rd west coast conference on formal linguistics*, 128–136.
- Gerasimova, Anastasia. 2015. Licensing negative pronouns in Russian infinitives. *Tipologiya Morfosintaksicheskikh Parametrov. Materialy Mezhdunarodnoi Konferentsii Tipologiya Morfosintaksicheskikh Parametrov 2015* 47–61.
- Giannakidou, Anastasia. 2000. Negative... concord? *Natural Language & Linguistic Theory* 18(3). 457–523.
- Giannakidou, Anastasia & Josep Quer. 1997. Long-distance licensing of negative indefinites. *Amsterdam Studies in the Theory and History of Linguistic Science* 4. 95–114.
- Grano, Thomas. 2011. Mental action and event structure in the semantics of 'try'. In *Semantics and linguistic theory*, 426–443.
- Grano, Thomas. 2015. *Control and restructuring*, vol. 56. Oxford University Press.
- Grano, Thomas. 2017. Control, temporal orientation, and the cross-linguistic grammar of trying. *Glossa: a journal of general linguistics* 2(1).
- Greenberg, Gerald R & Steven Franks. 1991. A parametric approach to dative subjects and the second dative in slavic. *Slavic and East European Journal* 71–97.
- Gribanova, Vera. 2017. Head movement and ellipsis in the expression of Russian polarity focus. *Natural Language & Linguistic Theory* 35. 1079–1121.
- Hornstein, Norbert. 1999. Movement and control. *Linguistic inquiry* 30(1). 69–96.
- Hornstein, Norbert. 2003. On control. *Minimalist syntax* 6–81.
- Kholodilova, Maria. 2015. Inter-clausal negative concord in Russian. *Poster presented at The Pragmatics of Grammar: Negation and Polarity. Caen* 19–20.
- Ladusaw, William A. 1992. Expressing negation. In *Semantics and linguistic theory*, 237–260.
- Laka, Itziar. 1990. *Negation in syntax—on the nature of functional categories and projections*: Massachusetts Institute of Technology dissertation.
- Laka, Itziar. 1992. Negative complementizers: evidence from English, basque and spanish. *Anuario del Seminario de Filología Vasca "Julio de Urquijo"* 175–211.
- Landau, Idan. 2001. *Elements of control: Structure and meaning in infinitival constructions*, vol. 51. Springer Science & Business Media.
- Landau, Idan. 2002. (Un)interpretable Neg in Comp. *Linguistic Inquiry* 33(3). 465–492.
- Landau, Idan. 2008. Two routes of control: Evidence from case transmission in Russian. *Natural language & linguistic theory* 26. 877–924.
- Landau, Idan. 2013. *Control in generative grammar: A research companion*. Cambridge University Press.
- Landau, Idan. 2015. *A two-tiered theory of control*, vol. 71. MIT Press.
- Landau, Idan. 2017. Direct variable binding and agreement in obligatory control. In *Pronouns in embedded contexts at the syntax-semantics interface*, 1–41. Springer.
- Letuchiy, Alexander. 2017. Non-standard negative concord in Russian. *talk presented at Formal approaches to Russian Linguistics*.
- Lyutikova, Ekaterina. 2022. Does Russian attest syntactic raising? part 1: Infinitival clauses. *Moscow State University Bulletin. Series 9. Philology* (5). 27–45.
- Lyutikova, Ekaterina & Anastasia Gerasimova. 2023. Negative concord and locality in Russian. *Canadian Journal of Linguistics/Revue canadienne de linguistique* 68(1). 31–73.
- Lyutikova, Ekaterina & Sergei Tatevosov. 2020. Two facets of causality: On the syntax of causation verbs in Russian. *La Grammaire de la Cause-II* 89–108.

- Matthews, Stephen James. 1990. *A cognitive approach to the typology of verbal aspect*: University of Southern California dissertation.
- McFadden, Thomas & Sandhya Sundaresan. 2018. Reducing pro and PRO to a single source. *The Linguistic Review* 35(3). 463–518.
- McQuillan, Peter. 2016. Finite clause complementizers in Celtic. In *Complementizer semantics in european languages*, 15–74.
- Minor, Serge. 2013. Controlling the hidden restrictor: A puzzle with control in Russian. In *Proceedings of nels*, vol. 42, .
- Nespor, Marina & Irene Vogel. 2007. *Prosodic phonology: with a new foreword*, vol. 28. Walter de Gruyter.
- Partee, Barbara H, Vladimir Borschev, Elena V Paducheva, Yakov Testelests & Igor Yanovich. 2011. Russian genitive of negation alternations: The role of verb semantics. *Scando-Slavica* 57(2). 135–159.
- Pereltsvaig, Asya. 2004. Negative polarity items in Russian and the bagel problem. *Negation in Slavic* 153. 178.
- Pesetsky, David & Esther Torrego. 2007. The syntax of valuation and the interpretability of features. *Phrasal and clausal architecture* 262–294.
- Progovac, Ljiljana. 1993a. Locality and subjunctive-like complements in Serbo-Croatian. *Journal of Slavic linguistics* 116–144.
- Progovac, Ljiljana. 1993b. Negation and Comp. *Rivista di Linguistica* (5). 329–347.
- Richards, Norvin. 2016. *Contiguity theory*, vol. 73. MIT Press.
- Rossyaykin, Petr. 2022. Negative concord, fragments and (downward) agree. *Paper presented at WCCFL 40* .
- Ruda, Marta & Jacek Witkoś. 2024. What ellipsis teaches us about negative concord. *Strict Negative Concord in Slavic and Finno-Ugric: Licensing, Structure and Interpretation* 148. 63.
- Rudnev, Pavel. 2024. Two challenges for existentialist approaches to strict negative concord. *TABU* 312–328.
- Sharvit, Yael. 2003. Trying to be progressive: The extensionality of try. *Journal of semantics* 20(4). 403–445.
- Shimoyama, Junko. 2011. Japanese indeterminate negative polarity items and their scope. *Journal of Semantics* 28(4). 413–450.
- Surányi, Balázs. 2006. Quantification and focus in negative concord. *Lingua* 116(3). 272–313.
- Testelests, Yakov. 2001. Distributive quantifier float in Russian and some related constructions. In *Current issues in formal slavic linguistics*, 268–279.
- Tiskin, Daniel. 2016. Negative floating quantifiers: underestimated evidence for the stranding analysis? In *Proceedings of the international conference typology of morphosyntactic parameters*, vol. 3, 313–325.
- Ussery, Cherlon, Charles B Chang & Hannah J Haynie. 2008. What it means to agree: The behavior of case and phi features in Icelandic Control. In *Proceedings of the 26th west coast conference on formal linguistics*, 480–488.
- Wurmbrand, Susanne. 2001. *Infinitives: Restructuring and clause structure*, vol. 55. Walter de Gruyter.

- Wurmbrand, Susi & Magdalena Lohninger. 2023. An implicational universal in complementation: Theoretical insights and empirical progress. *Propositional arguments in cross-linguistic research: Theoretical and empirical issues* 183–232.
- Zeijlstra, Hedde. 2004. *Sentential negation and negative concord*: dissertation.
- Zeijlstra, Hedde. 2008. Negative concord is syntactic agreement. *Ms., University of Amsterdam* 5. 113.
- Zeijlstra, Hedde. 2011. On the syntactically complex status of negative indefinites. *The Journal of Comparative Germanic Linguistics* 14. 111–138.